EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The PLP 2024-25 maps the potential in priority sectors which could be exploited with institutional credit within a specified time frame. PLP is intended to provide a meaningful direction to the flow of credit to different sectors at the ground level taking into account all relevant factors. The various linkages and other support required to be provided by line departments to facilitate credit flow as planned are also listed in the PLP.

1. District Characteristics

The name Darrang was derived from the Bodo word 'Dourang', which means 'Lilabhumi' (Playground) of Gods. The District of Darrang was created with effect from July'1983 by converting the erstwhile Sub-Division of Mangaldai. The district is situated at a distance of 68 kms from Guwahati. The district is situated in the North Bank Plain Zone and has a total geographical area of 1585 sq. km. Agriculture is the predominant economic activity of the District, engaging about 85% of the population directly or indirectly. Paddy is the dominant crop, cultivated in around 58022 ha area, as per Statistical Handbook 2022. Allied activities such as fishery, dairy, poultry, piggery, sericulture are also in vogue. About 64% of the farmers are in marginal and small farmers' category. Weaving is an important household activity in the District. As per 2011 Census, the population of the district is 928500. The gross cropped area vis-a-vis net sown area was 133670 ha and 73619 ha during 2022-23, as per Dept. of Agriculture, Darrang. There are 4 medium to large Tea Gardens owned by corporate houses and around 165 Small Tea Gardens.

2. Coverage of Banking Network and its financial performance.

Altogether there are 78 bank branches involving CBs, RRBs, StCB and Coop. Societies. Deposit outstanding as on 31.03.2023 is Rs.2918.42 crore, with advance of Rs.2019.49 crore. CD Ratio as on March 2023 is 69.20%.

The performance under ACP 2022-23 has recorded a significant improvement and banks could achieved 211.83% of the target. Although, performance under crop loan has decreased from Rs.6470.91 lakh during 2020-21 to Rs.5854.17 lakh during 2022-23, but credit towards Agri. Term Loan has recorded a positive growth over the previous few years and during 2022-23, banks have disbursed an amount of Rs. 157.93 crore, an achievement of 210.19% of the target. Credit disbursement under MSME sector has experienced a disbursement of Rs.23096.15 lakh during 2020-21, Rs.13178.97 lakh and Rs.28384.89 lakh during 2022-23.

3. Sectoral trends in credit flow

The achievement under the Annual Credit Plan for the year 2022-23 was 211.83%. Under Crop loan, Banks have disbursed an amount of Rs.5854.17 lakh during 2022-23. The flow of ground level credit of the district under priority sector stood at Rs.871.05 Cr during 2022-23, of which Agriculture accounted for 24.85%. The ACP disbursement under MSME sector has shown steady growth and achieved more than 100% against ACP disbursement over past three years. MSME accounted for 32.59% of ACP disbursement in the year 2022-23.

4. Sector/ Sub-Sector wise PLP Projections for 2024-25

At this backdrop, the credit potential for 2024-25 has been projected at Rs.88737.01 lakh under priority sector bank credit. Total farm credit has been projected at Rs.50869.38 lakh. There exists phenomenal potential of credit growth under crop loan, mainly due to enhancement of Scale of Finance and additional thrust on crop loans through KCC. Accordingly, projection of Rs.35670.94 lakh has been made under crop loan. The potential for investment credit under agriculture and allied sectors viz., Water Resources, Farm Mechanisation, Plantation and Horticulture, Forestry, Dairy Development, Poultry, Sheep/Goat/Pig rearing, Fisheries, and Other activities has been projected at Rs.15198.44 lakh. Potential for Agriculture Infrastructure creation is pegged at Rs.1513.55 lakh, whereas it is set at Rs.3115.60 lakh for Agriculture Ancillary Activities. Overall credit potential for agriculture has been pegged at Rs. 55498.53

lakh. Credit potential for Term loan and Working Capital for Development of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) has been projected at Rs.25120.00 lakh. There is urgent need to create a favourable credit environment for the MSME sector in the district to maintain this growth rate.

Potential for Self-Employment under Non-Farm Sector, Export Credit, Education, Housing, Social Infrastructure and Renewable Energy credit projections have been estimated at Rs.4032.48 lakh. The informal credit to grass level institutions viz., Self Help Groups and Joint Liability Groups has been projected at Rs. 4086.00 lakhs.The potential has been assessed keeping in view the GoI/GoA's priorities, existing/likely improvements in infrastructure, past GLC flow, revision in SoF/Unit Cost and various subsidy schemes of GoI/GoA.

An amount of Rs. 16155.03 lakh has been projected in respect of Pub Mangaldai block of the district covered under Aspirational Block's programme of NITI Aayog.

5. Developmental Initiatives:

Several developmental interventions from NABARD are operational in the Darrang district. During 2022-23, NABARD had implemented 03 Micro Enterprise Development Programmes (MEDPs) and 1 Livelihood and Enterprise Development Programme (LEDPs) in the district covering 210 Women SHG members. During the last financial year, training programmes were organised across the district involving more than 500 SHG members. Two number of Farmers Producer Organization (FPOs) have been promoted by NABARD in the district which are operational which have aggregated more than 600 farmers with an objective of improving income by rationalizing cost of production and easing of market linkages. During the year a millet FPO has also been formed. Under the ambitious Central Sector Scheme – promotion of 10,000 FPOs, two more FPOs have also been promoted in Dalgaon and Bechimari blocks with vegetables as core crop.

6. Thrust Areas for 2024-25

The farmers will be able to obtain greater share of the consumer price Focus on availing of Value chain services, storage facilities and market linkages through aggregation and collectivization (in the form of PACS/ FPOs). Additionally, implementation of SHG, JLG, RuPay enabled KCC and Financial Inclusion drive through banks will ultimately result in achieving the objective of inclusive growth in the rural areas of the district.

7. Major constraints and suggested action points for State Govt. and banking sector

Low growth in agriculture has been observed due to farmers' ignorance, low level of capital formation and poor quality of physical infrastructure. Bank credit can act as a catalyst for capital formation. However, its efficacy would be largely dependent on the delivery efficiency of non-credit inputs such as infrastructure and extension services, which would go hand in hand to reduce farmers' ignorance. The flow of GLC during the past years has not been satisfactory. The Govt. may also consider strengthening the existing extension network, technology transfer mechanism, improving irrigation facilities, popularisation of improved and affordable agricultural implements/ machinery through establishment of custom hiring centres. Apart from the above, few other infrastructural areas which needs attention are popularizing high density cropping systems, tiered farming system, improving animal health care, activating/increasing the milk routes, improving road network, uninterrupted power supply to the industries, etc. Govt. may also encourage private investment in the district for setting up of warehouses, micro warehouses, cold storages/cold chains, etc. In order to achieve the PLP projections made for the year 2024-25, following action points have been suggested:

- Adequate and timely availability of inputs like HYV seeds, fertilizer, pesticides etc. may be ensured by the Agriculture department.
- Farmers may be motivated for taking up cultivation of high yielding crops varieties, using bio-fertilizers/bio-pesticides and adopting changes in cropping pattern for higher returns.

- Implementation of farmer mechanization through promotion of customer hiring centres by farmer co-operatives.
- Banks, line departments and extension arms should come forward to encourage adoption of Integrated Farming System in the district.
- Improving the power situation particularly in rural area for establishing and managing agro and food processing activities

8. Way Forward

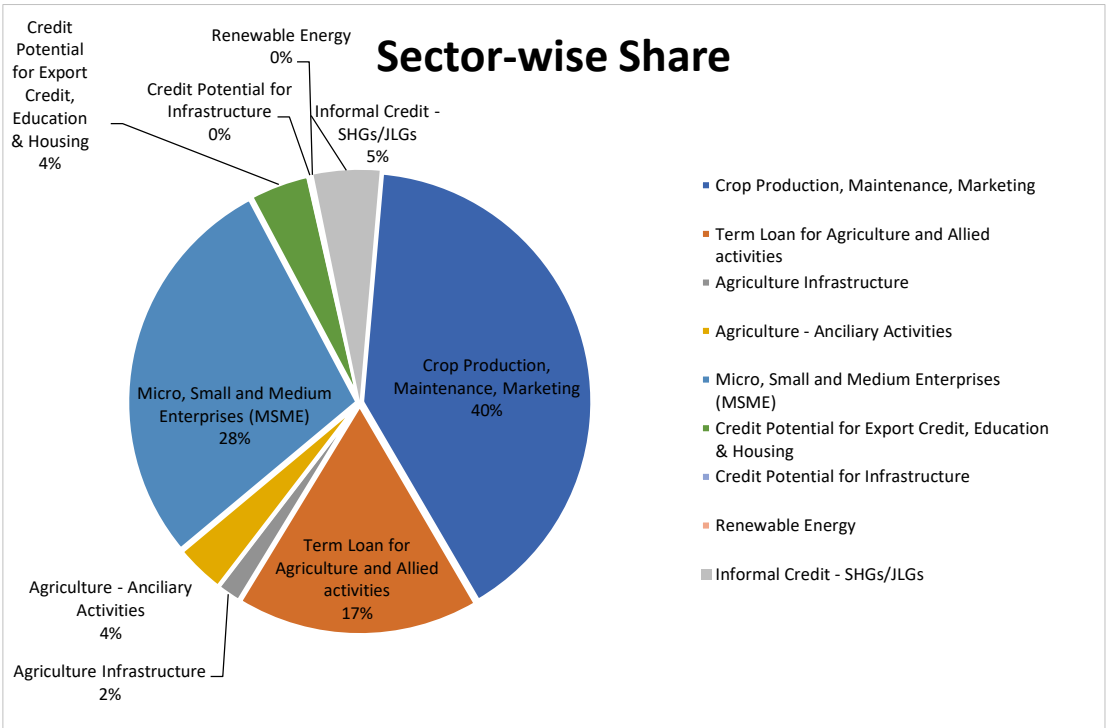
Timely and adequate disbursement of Credit and financial literacy of farmers to ensure timely repayment will lead to a healthy ecosystem. It is envisaged that concerted efforts of all stakeholders shall provide a fillip to the district economy in right direction.

Broad Sector wise PLP Projections 2024-25

District: Darrang **State: Assam**

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Particulars	PLP Projections 2024-25
A	**Farm Credit**	
i	Crop Production, Maintenance, Marketing	35670.94
ii	Term Loan for Agriculture and Allied activities	15198.44
	Sub Total	**50869.38**
B	**Agriculture Infrastructure**	1513.55
C	**Agriculture - Ancillary Activities**	3115.60
I	**Credit Potential for Agriculture (A+B+C)**	**55498.53**
II	**Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME)**	25120.00
III	**Credit Potential for Export Credit, Education & Housing**	3728.00
IV	**Credit Potential for Infrastructure**	216.00
V	**Renewable Energy**	88.48
VI	**Informal Credit - SHGs/JLGs**	**4086.00**
	Total Priority Sector (I to V)	**88737.01**



SECTOR / SUB-SECTOR WISE PROJECTIONS- 2024-25

District: Darrang **State: Assam**

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Particulars	PLP Projections 2024-25
I	**Credit Potential for Agriculture**	
A	**Farm Credit**	
i	Crop Production, Maintenance, Marketing	35670.94
ii	Water Resources	784.85
iii	Farm Mechanization	3239.12
iv	Plantation & Horticulture including Sericulture	1463.95
v	Forestry and Wasteland Development	111.32
vi	Animal Husbandry – Dairy	2616.71
vii	Animal Husbandry - Poultry	2330.05
viii	Animal Husbandry –Sheep, Goat, Piggery, etc.	1614.82
ix	Fisheries	2314.10
x	Farm Credit- Others, including Two Wheelers for Farmers	52.80
xi	Sustainable Agriculture Practices	670.72
	Sub Total	**50869.38**
B	**Agriculture Infrastructure**	
i	Construction of storage and Marketing Infrastructure	942.00
ii	Land Development, Soil Conservation, Watershed Development	408.35
iii	Agriculture Infrastructure - Others	163.20
	Sub Total	**1513.55**
C	**Agriculture - Ancillary Activities**	
i	Food & Agro Processing	2225.60
ii	Agriculture - Ancillary Activities - Others	890.00
	Sub Total	**3115.60**
II	**Total Agriculture**	**55498.53**
III	**Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME)**	
(a)	MSME - Term Loan	16400.00
(b)	MSME - Working Capital	8720.00
	Total MSME	**25120.00**
IV	**Credit Potential for Export Credit, Education & Housing**	**3728.00**
a.	Export Credit	40.00
b.	Education	1200.00
c.	Housing	2488.00
V	**Credit Potential for Infrastructure**	**304.48**
a.	**Social Infrastructure Involving Bank Credit**	216.00
b.	**Renewable Energy**	88.48
VI	**Informal Credit - SHGs/JLGs**	4086.00
	Total Priority Sector	**88737.01**

District Profile

जिला प्रोफ़ाइल / District Profile

जिला / District	Darrang	राज्य / State	Assam

1. भौतिक एवं प्रशासनिक विशेषताएँ / PHYSICAL & ADMINISTRATIVE FEATURES

कुल भौगोलिक क्षेत्र (वर्ग किलोमीटर) / Total Geographical Area (sq.km)	1585
उपमंडलों की संख्या / No. of Sub Divisions	1
ब्लॉक्स की संख्या / No. of Blocks	5+1(part)
राजस्व गाँवों की संख्या / No. of revenue villages	552
ग्राम पंचायतों की संख्या / No. of Gram Panchayats	76

2. मृदा और जलवायु / SOIL & CLIMATE

कृषि जलवायु अंचल / Agro-climatic Zone	NORTH BANK PLAIN ZONE
जलवायु / Climate	Sub-tropical
मृदा प्रकार / Soil Type	Old to new alluvium, sandy to sandy loam and clay

3. भूमि उपयोग (हेक्टेयर) / LAND UTILISATION [ha]

रिपोर्ट किया गया कुल क्षेत्र / Total Area Reported	158500
वनभूमि / Forest Land	7927
क्षेत्र जो खेती के लिए उपलब्ध नहीं है / Area not available for cultivation	33513
चरागाह और गोचर भूमि / Permanent Pasture and Grazing Land	5704
विविध वृक्ष फसलों के अंतर्गत आने वाली भूमि / Land under Miscellaneous Tree Crops	5248
कृष्य बंजर भूमि / Cultivable Wasteland	3508
वर्तमान परती भूमि / Current Fallow	9802
अन्य परती भूमि / Other Fallow	3325
बोया गया निवल क्षेत्र / Net Sown Area	73619
कुल अथवा सकल फसली क्षेत्र / Total or Gross Cropped Area	133670
एक से ज्यादा बार कृषि क्षेत्र / Area Cultivated More than Once	25064
फसल गहनता सीसीए एनएसए / Cropping Intensity [GCA/NSA]	181.56

4. वर्षा और भूमिगत जल परिदृश्य / RAINFALL & GROUND WATER SCENARIO

वर्षा (मिलीमीटर) / Rainfall [in mm]		साधारण Normal	वास्तविक Actual	2019-20	2020-21	2021-22
		2000		2337	2337	3151
भूजल की स्थिति / Ground Water Scenario	Stage of G.W. Dpt.	खंडों की संख्या / No of Blocks				
		सुरक्षित / Safe	जोखिमग्रस्त / Critical	कम जोखिम / Semi Critical	ओवरएक्सप्लोइटेड / Over Exploited	कुल / Total
		6	0	0	0	6

5. भूमि जोत का विवरण / DISTRIBUTION OF LAND HOLDING

भूजोत का वर्गीकरण / Classification of Holding	भूजोत / Holding		क्षेत्र / Area	
	Nos.	कुल का % / % to Total	हेक्टेयर / ha.	कुल का % / % to Total
<= 1 ha	52598	52	17378	21
>1 to <=2 ha	37755	37	42025	51
>2 ha	11522	11	23399	28
कुल / Total	101875	100	82802	100

6. कर्मचारी प्रोफ़ाइल ('000 में) / WORKERS PROFILE [in '000]

खेतिहर / Cultivators	107
उपर्युक्त में से छोटे और सीमांत कृषक / Of the above, Small/ Marginal Farmers	68
कृषि मजदूर / Agricultural Labourers	46
घरेलू उद्योगों में लगे कारीगर / Workers engaged in Household Industries	4
कृषि संबंधित गतिविधियों में लगे कारीगर / Workers engaged in Allied agro activities	41
अन्य कर्मी / Other workers	107

7. जनसांख्यिकी प्रोफ़ाइल ('000 में) / DEMOGRAPHIC PROFILE [in '000]

श्रेणी / Category	कुल / Total	पुरुष / Male	महिला / Female	ग्रामीण / Rural	शहरी / Urban
जनसंख्या / Population	928	475	453	873	55
अनुसूचित जाति / Scheduled Caste	40	20	20	NA	NA
अनुसूचित जनजाति / Scheduled Tribe	8	4	4	NA	NA
साक्षर / Literate	63.08	67.87	58.04	61.50	85.92
बीपीएल / BPL					

8. गृहस्थ परिवार ('000 में) / HOUSEHOLDS [in '000]

कुल गृहस्थ परिवार / Total Households	187
ग्रामीण गृहस्थ परिवार / Rural Households	175
बीपीएल गृहस्थ परिवार / BPL Households	NA

9. घरेलू सुविधाएं (संख्या '000 घरों में) / HOUSEHOLD AMENITIES [Nos. in '000 Households]

ईंट/पत्थर/कंक्रीट के घर / Having brick/stone/concrete houses	85	बिजली की आपूर्ति / Having electricity supply	65
पीने के पानी का स्रोत / Having source of drinking water	105	स्वतंत्र शौचालय होना / Having independent toilets	95

10. ग्राम स्तरीय आधारभूत संरचना / VILLAGE-LEVEL INFRASTRUCTURE [Nos]

विद्युतीकृत गाँव / Villages Electrified	541	आंगनवाड़ी / Anganwadis	993
गाँव जिनमें डाकघर हो / Villages having Post Offices	71	औषधालय / Dispensaries	14
गाँव जिनमें बैंकिंग की सुविधा हो / Villages having Banking Facilities	552	प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केंद्र / Primary Health Centres	47
गाँव जिनमें प्राथमिक विद्यालय हो / Villages having Primary Schools	NA	अस्पताल / Hospitals	1
गाँव जिनमें प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य केंद्र हो / Villages having Primary Health Centres	191	प्राथमिक स्वास्थ्य उपकेंद्र / Primary Health Sub-Centres	163
गाँव जिनमें पेयजल आपूर्ति की सुविधा हो / Villages having Potable Water Supply	2305	अस्पताल में बेड की संख्या / Hospital Beds	444
पक्की प्रोच सड़कों से जुड़े गाँव / Villages connected with Paved Approach Roads	444		

12. कृषि के लिए आधारभूत संरचना और सेवाएं (संख्या) / INFRASTRUCTURE & SUPPORT SERVICES FOR AGRICULTURE[Nos]

बीज फार्म / Seed Farms	300	कृषि सेवा केंद्र / Agro Service Centres	1
उर्वरक केंद्र / Fertilizer Outlets		मृदा परीक्षण केंद्र / Soil Testing Centres	Nil
कीटनाशक केंद्र / Pesticide Outlets		पंजीकृत नर्सरी / Approved nurseries	1
पंजीकृत एफपीओ / Registered FPOs	24	कृषि विज्ञान केंद्र / Krishi Vigyan Kendras	1

13. सिंचाई (हेक्टेयर में) / IRRIGATION COVERAGE [Ha]

सिंचाई के लिए उपलब्ध क्षेत्र (एनआईए परती भूमि) / Area Available for Irrigation (NIA + Fallow)	65284
सृजित सिंचाई क्षमता / Irrigation Potential Created	32290
निवल सिंचित क्षेत्र (कम से कम एक बार सिंचित क्षेत्र) / Net Irrigated Area (Total area irrigated at least once)	18690
नहर/चैनल द्वारा सिंचित क्षेत्र / Area irrigated by Canals / Channels	91
कुएं द्वारा सिंचित क्षेत्र / Area irrigated by Wells	763
तालाब से सिंचित क्षेत्र / Area irrigated by Tanks	
अन्य स्रोतों से सिंचित क्षेत्र / Area irrigated by Other Sources	
उपयोग की जाने वाली सिंचाई क्षमता (सकल सिंचित क्षेत्र) / Irrigation Potential Utilized (Gross Irrigated Area)	854

14. भंडारण, परिवहन और विपणन के लिए आधारभूत संरचना / INFRASTRUCTURE FOR STORAGE, TRANSPORT & MARKETING

मंडी बाजार (संख्या) / Mandis/ Markets [Nos]	8	भंडारगृह (संख्या) / Godown [Nos]	8
पक्के रोड की लंबाई किलोमीटर में / Length of Pucca Road [km]	916	भंडारगृह की क्षमता / Godown Capacity [MT]	18650
रेल्वे लाइन की लंबाई किलोमीटर में / Length of Railway Line [km]	Nil	कोल्ड स्टोरेज (संख्या) / Cold Storage [Nos]	Nil
माल परिवहन गाड़ियाँ (संख्या) / Goods Transport Vehicles [Nos]	NA	कोल्ड स्टोरेज की क्षमता (एमटी) / Cold Store Capacity [MT]	Nil

15. प्रसंस्करण इकाइयाँ / PROCESSING UNITS

प्रसंस्करण गतिविधि का प्रकार / Type of Processing Activity	इकाइयों की संख्या / No of units
खाद्य प्रसंस्करण / Food Processing	23
कृषि प्रसंस्करण / Agro Processing	69

16. प्रमुख फसलों का क्षेत्र, उत्पादन और उपज / AREA, PRODUCTION & YIELD OF MAJOR CROPS

फसल / Crop	क्षेत्र / Area ('000 ha)	उत्पादन / Prod. ('000 MT)	उत्पादकता / Productivity kg/ha	औसत उत्पादकता / Avg. Yield
Cereals	74594	274013	3673.39	13.81
Pulses	6731	5735.94	852.17	0.85
Oilseed crops	22638	14573.54	0.64	0.64
Fibre crop & sugarcane	4205	58020	13797.85	43.21
Horticulture crops including spices and vegetables	26978	317065	11752.72	149.5

कपास लिंट का उत्पादन गांठों में है (भारत में 177.8 किलोग्राम प्रति गांठ) / Production of Cotton (lint) is in Bales(177.8 kg per bale in India)

17. पशुजनगणना के अनुसार पशुओं की संख्या / ANIMAL POPULATION AS PER CENSUS [Nos]

पशु की श्रेणी / Category of animal	कुल / Total	नर / Male	मादा / Female
मवेशी संकर नस्ल / Cattle-Cross bred	457426	NA	NA
मवेशी स्वदेशी / Cattle - Indigenous		NA	NA
भैंस / Buffaloes	37070	NA	NA
भेड़ संकर नस्ल / Sheep-Cross bred	35088	NA	NA
भेड़ स्वदेशी / Sheep - Indigenous		NA	NA
बकरी / Goat	161879	NA	NA
शूकर संकर नस्ल / Pig - Cross bred	21665	NA	NA
शूकर स्वदेशी / Pig - Indigenous		NA	NA
घोड़ा/गधा/ऊंट / Horse/Donkey /Camel	NA	NA	NA
मुर्गी संकर नस्ल / Poultry - Improved	770404	NA	NA
मुर्गी स्वदेशी / Poultry - Indigenous		NA	NA

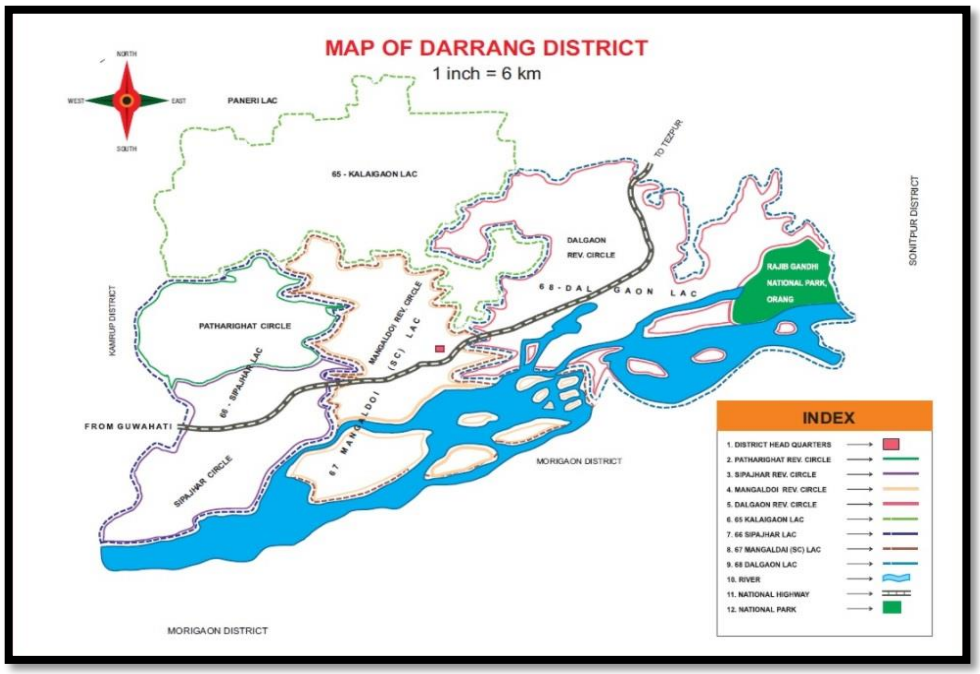
18. संबद्ध गतिविधियों के विकास के लिए आधारभूत संरचना (संख्या) / INFRASTRUCTURE FOR DEVELOPMENT OF ALLIED ACTIVITIES [Nos]

पशु चिकित्सालय/औषधालयों / Veterinary Hospitals/ Dispensaries	24	डेयरी सहकारी समितियां / Dairy Cooperative Societies	54
रोग निदान केंद्र / Disease Diagnostic Centres	0	दूध संग्रह केंद्र / Milk Collection Centres	3
कृत्रिम गर्भाधान केंद्र (संख्या) / Artificial Insemination Centers [Nos]	1	मछुआ सोसाइटी / Fishermen Societies	14
पशु प्रजनन फार्म / Animal Breeding Farms	Nil	मछली बीज फार्म / Fish seed farms	7
पशु आहार निर्माण इकाई (संख्या) / Animal feed manufacturing units [Nos]	Nil	पोल्ट्री हैचरी (संख्या) / Poultry hatcheries [Nos]	1
चारा फार्म (संख्या) / Fodder Farms [Nos]	Nil	लाइसेंसशुदा बूचड़खाने (संख्या) / Licensed Slaughter houses [Nos]	Nil

19. दूध, मछली, अंडा उत्पादन और प्रति व्यक्ति उपलब्धता / MILK, FISH, EGG PRODUCTION & PER CAPITA AVAILABILITY

मछली / Fish	उत्पादन (एमटी) / Production [MT]	13918.21	प्रति व्यक्ति उपलब्धता (ग्राम प्रति दिन) / Per cap avail. [gm/day]	13.82
अंडा / Egg	उत्पादन (लाख में) / Production [lakh Nos]	138.58	प्रति व्यक्ति उपलब्धता (अंडा प्रति वर्ष) / Per cap avail. [nos/p.a.]	10
दूध / Milk	उत्पादन (लाख लीटर प्रति दिन) / Production [lakh LPD]	91.03	प्रति व्यक्ति उपलब्धता (ग्राम प्रति दिन) / Per cap avail. [gm/day]	0.02
मांस / Meat	उत्पादन (एमटी) / Production [MT]	7263500	प्रति व्यक्ति उपलब्धता (ग्राम प्रति दिन) / Per cap avail. [gm/day]	19900

Sources (if not mentioned against the respective item): Item Nos. 1, 6, 7, 8, 9 & 10 - Census 2011; Item Nos. 2, 3, 5, 12, 13 & 14 - Dept. of Agr/Dir. of Eco. & Stat.; Item No. 4 - Dept. of Agr./Water Resources & CGWB Report 2022; Item No. 8 - NREGA Report; Item No. 15 - District Ind Centre/Dir. of Eco. & Stat.; Item No. 16 - DACNET & Dept. of Agr/Dir. of Eco. & Stat; Item No. 17 - AH Census 2019; Item Nos. 18 & 19 - Dept. of Animal Hus./Dir. of Eco. & Stat.



District Profile - Write up

Predominant Economic Activities

The economy of the Darrang district is basically agrarian where the majority (about 85%) of the population is engaged in agriculture and allied activities. The major crop grown in the district is Paddy. The district also produces various types of Horticulture crops mainly Banana, Brinjal, Melons, Assam Lemon, Mushroom etc. The gross cropped area and net sown area of the district is 133670 ha and 73619 ha respectively and the crop intensity was worked out at 181.56%. The Net Irrigated Area is only 25.38% of the Net Sown Area which indicates that most of the agriculture activities are rainfed and thus susceptible to the vagaries of the climate. Creation of irrigation infrastructures and rainwater harvesting structures will go a long way in bringing sustainability in agriculture production and enhance the income of the farmers. The average land holding per farmer family is less than 2 hectare. The total rice production in the district during the year 2022-23 was 148626 MT and total area covered under paddy was 58022 Ha.

As the district is nearby to Guwahati, majority of the populace engage themselves in day to day livelihood at Guwahati, however, a few good social organizations have mandated in order to uplift the district. Many of the NGOs are engaged with the State govt in order to uplift the district in Agriculture & Rural development. These NGOs are also working with NABARD in the district thereby fulfilling our mandate towards rural prosperity, through various of our interventions like millet mission, FPOs, agri value chain activities.

Factors/infrastructure contributing or inhibiting the growth in Ground Level Credit (GLC)

The important factors causing impediment towards agriculture prosperity is practice of mono-cropping and recurrence of annual floods. Cropping intensity stood at 181.56%. In addition to this, recovery of over-dues have become an increasing concern for banks, which accounted for drop in crop loan disbursement year on year and subsequently inhibiting growth in GLC in agri & allied sector.

Critical interventions required in the district under major sectors for harnessing the potential estimated under PLP 2024-25

In order to achieve the PLP projections made for the year 2024-25, following action points have been suggested –

- Coverage of more numbers of farmers under PMFBY, which is in implementation.
- Provision of adequate quantity of water supply through Irrigation by Govt. Effective utilization of operating schemes of Deptt. Implementation of PMKSY the concerned deptts effectively.
- Coverage of eligible farmers under KCC by Banks on a cluster basis and proper identification of farmers. Special emphasis on scaling up of KCC to Animal Husbandry as well as Fishery sector
- Timely credit disbursement under Agriculture Term lending should be emphasized by banks as it would have a long term impact on economic growth.
- Focus to be given by the banks towards diversifications in the loan portfolios.
- Recovery of overdues which have become an increasing concern for banks should be given priority and strong mechanism of monitoring and recovery should be established by the banks.
- Proper co-ordination among banks, Govt Departments to ensure effective implementation of schemes.
- Financing of post-harvest management infrastructure by the banks to entrepreneur, farmer collectives, SHG federations by Banks under Agri Infrastructure Fund.

CHAPTER – 2

2.1 Farm Credit

2.1.1 Crop Production, Maintenance & Marketing

2.1.1.1. Status of the sector in the district

Farming is the major occupation in Darrang district. The district falls under the North Bank Plains Agro climatic zone. The normal Gross Cropped Area and Net Sown Area for the district are 1,33,670 hectare and 73,619 hectare respectively. During the past 10 years, the GCA expanded in Darrang district in the range of 1124 hectare. The Net sown area constituted about 46.44 % of the total Geographical area, which is 1,58,500 hectare. Out of the Net sown area, 25.38 % is irrigated and the remaining is under rain fed cultivation. The cropping intensity of the district is 181.56%. About 89% of land holdings are with small and marginal farmers and the average size of the holdings is 0.92 hectare. Hence, the small and marginal farmers are the decisive factor in influencing the growth of farm sector in the district. Winter Paddy is the major crop grown in the district occupying about 35.65% of the GCA while rape & mustard seeds and jute are the other major crops sharing about 15% and 0.26% of the GCA respectively. Department of Agriculture is implementing various centre and state government schemes in the district to promote a diversified cropping pattern. Crop wise gross area covered in Darrang district- 2022-23.

Sl. No	Name of Commodity	Area under Cultivation (ha)	Percentage (%)	Remarks
01	Cereals	74594	55.80	Includes paddy, maize, wheat, millet & other cereals
02	Pulses	6731	5.04	Green/black gram, lentils, peas, arhar, others
03	Oilseeds	22,638	16.94	Rape & mustard, linseed, castor, ground nut, etc.
04	Fibre Crops	3827	2.86	Jute, cotton, mesta, sugarcane
05	Sugar Crops	378	0.28	Potato, Sweet potato
06	Kharif Vegetables	5080	3.80	Tomato, okra, peas
07	Rabi Vegetables	12157	9.09	Soyabean, rajma, grass pea
08	Spices & Condiments	3,167	2.37	Garlic, coriander, black pepper, ginger, turmeric
10	Fruits	5,098	3.81	Pineapple, banana, coconut, papaya, assam lemon, guava, litchi
	Total	**1,33,670**	**100.00**	

(District Agriculture dept, Darrang)

Consumption of fertilizer during 2021-22

	Nitrogen (N)	Phosphorous (P)	Muriate of Potash (K)	Total (N+P+K)	Consumption (Kg / ha)
Darrang	11.340	4.512	2.019	17.870	148.680
Assam	163.019	44.950	32.588	240.629	61.373

(Source – Assam statistical handbook-2022)

- Procurement of Paddy (Rs.2183/- per quintal) and mustard (Rs.5450/- per quintal) is being encouraged (target for state: Paddy : 10 lakh MT , Mustatd : 45,700 MT)
- **Incentive to Activate Dormant KCCs** incentive of Rs.3000/- to every farmer on activating his dormant Kisan Credit Card.
- **Zero interest on crop loans**

  Govt. of Assam will provide 4% interest subvention in addition to the Govt. of India 3% incentive to the farmers for prompt repayment for loans upto Rs.2 lakh. The effective rate for such loans would therefore become zero for the farmers.
- **Scheme for Tractor Financing under CMSGUY**

  Govt. of Assam is implementing a new scheme of providing a tractor to a group of farmers in every revenue village at a subsidy of 70%.
- **Ru-pay KCC for every farmer in Assam a** special intervention to be implemented jointly by Govt. of Assam, NABARD and the banks in Assam to issue 8 lakh new KCC to universalize coverage of KCC in the state.
- **Interest Subvention Scheme for short term crop loan.** The Union Cabinet has approved an interest subvention of 1.5 per cent per annum on short-term agriculture loan up to Rs 3 lakh to ensure adequate credit flow in the agriculture sector. It has been conveyed that Interest Subvention of 1.5 per cent will be provided to lending institutions (Public Sector Banks, Private Sector Bank, Small Finance Banks, Regional Rural Banks, Co-operative Banks for the financial year 2022-23 to 2024-25 for lending short term agri-loans upto Rs.3 lakh to the farmers.
- **PM-KISAN :** The Govt. of India has introduced the **Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi** scheme in which 120 million small and marginal farmers who have less than 2 hectares of landholding will get up to Rs.6,000 per year as minimum income support.
- **Government of Assam has announced implementation of the following schemes:** The Chief Minister's Samagra Gramya Unnayan Yojana (CMSGUY) was launched as a Mega Mission promoting nine Sub-Missions. Dept. of Agri to bring in modifications in the scheme – Distribution of Mini Rice Mill, Distribution of Mini Truck, Distribution of Combined Harvestor, Fortified Rice Kernel Blending Machine, Distribution of 1000 units of submersible solar pump and 500 units of grid connected individual agri pumps. Govt. of Assam has prepared a VISION PLAN (AGRI VISION 2025), keeping food security, employment generation and sustainability of agricultural production in its core. The focus is on self-sufficiency of food grains, oilseeds and horticultural products. The areas of intervention to be (i) large-scale shallow tube well irrigation, (ii) thrust to value addition in horticulture produce, (iii) Integrated Nutrient Management like use of organic manures, bio-fertilizers and green manuring to maintain soil health, (iv) attaining self-sufficiency in seed production, (v) conservation of natural resources, (vi) increased area and production of pulses, oilseeds and food cereals.
- As 2023 is the International Year of Millet, NABARD has initiated a Model Millet Project in the district to give fillip and introduce commercial cultivation of Millet. Under the project, 50 farmers have taken up Foxtail Millet cultivation in 150 Bigha of Land in Sipajhar and Paschim Mangaldoi. This initiative is expected to help in more farmers being drawn towards millet cultivation, especially in the light of Governments decision to introduce millet as part of mid-day meal scheme.
- In the district, 2 FPOs under Central sector scheme are currently operational – both of which with vegetables as focus crop – in Dalgaon and Bechimari area. Both the FPOs are promoted by AAU, Jorhat.
- Total number of KCC issued in the district as on 31 March 2023 stood at 36299, with an outstanding amount of Rs. 21577 lakh. Number of Rupay KCC card stood at 18056.

2.1.1.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps

Majority of the cultivation in the district is rainfed. Darrang receives total rainfall about 1700 mm to 1880 mm per year and more than 70% distributed in 7 months i.e. from April to October. Irrigated area has increased with the installation of STW, mainly in Boro rice and also in vegetable area. Net irrigated area in the district stood at 18690 ha, of which 6485 ha is contributed from surface flow (canals). In winter season, rainfall is less and crops suffer from water stress and need irrigation. Even in areas with higher rainfall there is need of irrigation in critical periods.

- **Availability of support services**:

District Agriculture Office through 3 Agricultural Sub-divisions, 13 Agri. Dev. Officers manning the Agriculture Circles and 116 AEAs facilitate agriculture development and implement various policies & projects of State/Central Government and other agencies in the district. There are 21 GPSS and 1264 Field Management Committees (FMC) or Pathar Parichalana Samities (PPS). Supplies of various agricultural inputs are taken care of by Retail agents/traders. 02 seed farms under the Department & ASC Ltd. have been leased out. However, extension services in the District suffer due to large number of vacancy in the post of AEAs.

- **Marketing Facility:**

Agricultural market infrastructure in the district is dominated by middlemen. Lack of storage facilities, poor means of transport and communication etc., are the major constraints. There is one regulated market at Kharupetia. Jute Corporation of India has one procurement centre at Kharupetia. However, farmers have to sell most of their produce to middlemen at un-remunerative prices. Establishment of NEZONE Jute industries at Kharupetia provided farmers an opportunity to sell at remunerative prices.

National Food Security Mission (Rice) and Rashtriya Krishi Vikas Yojana are being implemented in the district. Demonstration of technologies, such as, SRI method for Rice, improved package of practices, use of hybrid seeds, development of seed village, distribution of Kono Weeder etc. were undertaken.

Establishment of ATMA has given a direction for development of agriculture sector and efforts at training and other supportive activities is likely to promote cultivation of crops with modern practices and thereby enhancing demand for credit.

The Krishi Vigyan Kendra - Darrang is providing technical inputs to farmers. This has the potential to enable more farmers adopt new/appropriate practices for crop cultivation as well as take up multiple cropping.

Ground Level Credit Flow

The quantum of crop loan extended by banks in the district is given below:

(Rs.lakh)

2018-19	2019-20	2020-21	2021-22	2022-23
7797.63	5048.34	3451.61	6470.91	5854.17

(Source: LBO, Darrang and SLBC)

The policy emphasis are on:

- Bringing green revolution in eastern region - to improve rice based cropping pattern by way of (i) increasing Seed Replacement Ratio (SRR), (ii) popularising System of Rice Intensification (SRI), (iii) creating seed storage facility with the help of NABARD and (iv) developing multi resistant crop varieties.

- Integrated development of pulses villages in rainfed areas.
- Increasing the production of millets.
- Promoting organic farming methods combining modern technology with traditional farming practices.
- In fact, as envisaged for the Second Green Revolution, the situation calls for a change in cropping pattern with greater emphasis on maize, millets and pulses.

2.1.1.3. Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25 (in both physical and financial terms)

The area under various crops have been carefully selected and based on expected GCA, existing policies and trends, the credit potential is assessed. Scale of Finance (SoF) finalized by the State Level Technical Committee (SLTC) has been considered for arriving at the estimates. Accordingly, the credit potential for Crop production/ Maintenance & Marketing activities in the district for 2024-25 is estimated at Rs.37693.36 lakh. The crop-wise physical and financial estimations are given in following table.

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Summer Paddy (Boro)	0.618	5700	3522.60	3522.60
ii	Winter Paddy (Sali)	0.717	15000	10752.00	10752.00
iii	Wheat	0.580	90	52.20	52.20
iv	Mustard/Rape	0.470	3450	1621.50	1621.50
v	Jute	0.634	450	285.12	285.12
vi	Potato	1.801	1350	2431.19	2431.19
vii	Chilli	1.034	950	982.42	982.42
viii	Brinjal	0.971	1000	971.08	971.08
ix	Peas	0.496	1250	620.00	620.00
x	Tomato	1.027	750	770.60	770.60
xi	Cabbage	1.136	1150	1306.65	1306.65
xii	Cauliflower	1.134	1200	1360.80	1360.80
xiii	Pulses (Black Gram/Green Gram)	0.477	740	353.13	353.13
xiv	Sugarcane	1.200	255	306.00	306.00
xv	Maize	0.543	1600	868.01	868.01
xvi	Autumn Paddy (Ahu)	0.724	1500	1085.70	1085.70
xvii	Hybrid Napier Grass	0.183	550	100.69	100.69
xviii	Fodder Maize	0.090	550	49.50	49.50
	Crop Loan Total		**37535**	**27439**	**27439**
	Add : 10% on Bank loan for Consumption/ Subsistence purpose			2743.92	2743.92
	Add : 20% for Repairs & Maintenance of Farm Assets			5487.84	5487.84
	Sub-Total		**37535**	**35670.94**	**35670.94**

The block-wise physical and financial projections are given in Annexure-I.

2.1.2 Water Resources

2.1.2.1 Status of the sector in the district

Topography of the district is generally plain with new as well as old alluvial soil and is drained

by a number of rivers and tributaries of the Brahmaputra. The district covers vast char areas in the south. The net ground water availability for future irrigation development is 57168 ham and the stage of ground water development is 31%. The net ground water availability for future irrigation development in the district is 24265 ham. The present stage of ground water development is 16%. {Source CGWB, NER, Guwahati-Assessment report on Dynamic Ground water Resources of Assam as on March, 2017}

As per data available with Central Ground Water Board regarding ground water utilization, all the blocks in the district are in the safe category. The ground water potential is very high in the district, while its exploitation is poor. Depth of water bearing stratum is around 25 to 35 metres (ground water table varies from 10 to 35 mtr during winter and 2 to 15 mtr during monsoon) and in Dumunichowki area Artesian wells are feasible.

Status of water availability

Sr. No.	MCM per Ha Sources	Kharif	Rabi and summer	Total
1	***Surface Irrigation***			
(i)	Canal(Major & Medium Irrigation)	Nil	Nil	Nil
(ii)	Minor Irrigation tanks	Nil	Nil	Nil
(iii)	Lift Irrigation/Diversion	1810	968	2778
2	***Ground Water***			
(i)	Deep Tube Well	1830	880	2710
(ii)	Shallow Tube Wells	30	20	50

Source: Office of Executive Engineer, Irrigation Department, Darrang

2.1.2.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned & gaps

There are two implementing agencies for irrigation projects in the district viz., Irrigation Department, which takes up Schemes mainly where the Command Area is more than 50 Ha and Agricultural Engineering Wing of Agriculture Department that takes up some key projects like Shallow Tube Wells (STWs), Low Lift Pump (LLP), Flow Irrigation etc. Most of the minor irrigation projects implemented in the district were funded under AACP with 70% subsidy and 30% beneficiary's contribution. As a result, credit to the sector is meager**.** Development of Minor Irrigation by way of STWs, LLP etc. under different programmes are being implemented by the engineering wing of Agriculture Department. Singrimari FIS constructed under RIDF-X has created on irrigation potential of 1038 ha. Under various tranches of RIDF, 23 minor irrigation projects have been implemented/ under implementation with RIDF assistance amounting Rs 30.34 crore. The irrigation projects in the primarily comprised of Flow and Lift irrigation schemes and construction of Deep Tube Wells (DTW).

The gross and net irrigated area in the district have been 854 hectares and 18690 hectares respectively during 2021-22 against a total irrigation potential created of 32290 hectares. While, the total rainfed area is 10922 hectares. Due to abundance of rainfall, the major portion of agriculture in the district is dependent on rainfed conditions, while only less area is cultivated under irrigated conditions.

Irrigation Based Classification

Irrigated (Area in Ha)			Rainfed (Area in ha)	
Irrigation potential created	**Irrigation Potential created**	**Net Irrigated Area**	**Partially Irrigated/Protective Irrigation**	**Un- Irrigated or Totally Rainfed**
32290	32290	18690	NA	10922

(Source: Assam Statistical Handbook 2021 & 2022)

The increase in cultivation of Rabi crops (especially vegetables) & Boro paddy (being the only crop for many flood ravaged farmers) results in consequential increase in demand for irrigation.

Irrigation Potential Utilisation

Irrigation plays a significant role in poverty reduction and economic growth. State Government is giving high priority to Irrigation Development. Agriculture constitutes the largest share of water consumption amongst various uses followed by the domestic and industrial uses. However, the irrigation potential utilization is below par and provides enormous scope of improvement. The status of irrigation potential created in the district vis a vis actual utilization is indicated below

	Major & Medium			Minor					
	Surface flow	**Surface lift**	**Total**	**Surface flow**	**Surface lift**	**DTW**	**STW**	**PMKSY HKKP Tube wells ph-1**	**Total**
Potential Created	0	0	0	26877	1808	3090	80	1065	32290
Utilized									763

(Source, Assam Statistical Handbook 2022)

Major Irrigation Scheme – Ongoing projects

There is a considerable potential for agricultural growth in the State by increasing cropping intensity, raising crop yield and diversifying into pulses and oilseeds through irrigation. Considering the uncertainties in the production of Kharif crop due to flood and high rainfall, the State Agriculture Department has laid greater emphasis on Rabi crops by assigning top priority to developing assured irrigation facilities through installation of Pump Sets (Shallow Tube Well & Low Lift Pump). Irrigation by way of Shallow Tube Well and Low Lift Pumps is considered to be an efficient method of water utilization for crop growth. As on 31 March 2022, the state has created irrigation potential of 10.59 lakh hectares. However, currently there are no major or medium irrigation projects in Darrang.

Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchai Yojana

Out of about 141 mha of net area sown in the country, about 65 million hectare (45%) is presently covered under irrigation. With view to address the water scarcity situations and ensuring more equitable use of water, the Govt. of India launched Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojana (PMKSY) during 2015-16, which envisage the concept of *"water for every farm"* and *"more crop per drop"* to which, NABARD is a key stakeholder. The main objectives of the scheme are to achieve convergence of investments in irrigation at the field level, enhance the physical access of water on the farm and expand cultivable area under assured irrigation for providing 'Har Khet Ko Pani'.Under this initiative, it is targeted to enhance irrigation efficiency by about 20% and creating 28.5 million ha additional area under irrigation. Under PMKSY-HKKP Tube wells (Ph 1) initiative, 1065 ha of irrigation potential have been in created in Darrang during 2021-22.
The GLC flow in Water Resources for last two years has been indicated below:

2020-21		2021-22	
No	**Amt. (Rs. lakh)**	**No**	**Amt. (Rs. lakh)**
0	0	3	4.92

2.1.2.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25:

The direct benefit in terms of production and productivity on account of increase in irrigation potential has resulted in grater enthusiasm among farmers. The shallow tube well is expected to become more popular in the coming years in the district. The ground level disbursement in the

sector is not at all encouraging. Considering the factors mentioned above PLP projection for 2024-25 is as follows:

(Rs. in lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Shallow Tube well (Dia -80 mm, depth - 45 m) with 5HP DPS	1.047	165	172.80	172.81
ii	Diesel Pump Set (5 HP)	0.350	185	64.75	64.75
iii	Shallow Tube well with Solar Photovoltaic (1 HP)	2.587	100	258.70	206.95
iv	STW (Dia-80mm, depth 45 m) with 2 HP EPS	0.454	170	77.23	77.24
v	STW with 2 HP Solar PV	3.614	91	328.87	263.10
	Sub- Total		**711**	**902.35**	**784.85**

The Block-wise and activity-wise potential assessed for the year 2024-25 is indicated in Annexure-I.

Climate Change

The Climate change affects the availability of water supply in agriculture. With the rise in temperature, the rate of evaporation of water into atmosphere also increases which dry out some areas and results in excess precipitation in some other areas. In order to mitigate the impact of climate change in agriculture, use of micro irrigation system viz drip, sprinkler, water harvesting technology etc. will result in efficient use of water in agriculture. Use of solar powered irrigation system in agriculture will reduce the coal/fossil fuel consumption and thus lead to improved climatic condition.

2.1.3 Farm Mechanization

2.1.3.1 Status of the sector in the district

The main objectives of Farm Mechanization are to increase the efficiency and timeliness of farm operations, reduction in cost of cultivation, efficient utilization of other agricultural inputs and improvement in quality of produce for better marketability. Farm Mechanisation also plays an important role in modernisation of agriculture. The extent of farm mechanization in the district is 0.45 hp / ha. The efficiency of mechanization can be judged from the fact that modern plough is about 200 to 300% efficient than indigenous plough. Efficient machinery helps in increasing productivity by about 30% besides, enabling the farmers to raise a second crop or multi crop making agriculture attractive and a way of life by becoming commercial instead of subsistence.

As a part of farm mechanization initiative, Government of Assam has been providing subsidy for purchase of tractors under group mode through Chief Minister's Samagra Gramya Unnayan Yojana (CMSGUY). It is assumed that this programme would continue during 2024-25.

2.1.3.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps

The current power availability to the farmers of the State is barely 0.3 HP per hectare. which has become one of the constraints towards increase of area under double or multiple cropping. It is obvious that farm mechanization is imperative to supplement the poor bullock draught power which is grossly inadequate to meet the challenging task of covering additional areas under cultivation. The density of Tractor is 0.26 per thousand hectare and that of Power Tiller is 0.51 per thousand hectare. Depending on the types of crops grown, soil conditions, local situations and requirements in the Districts, the Agriculture Department of Assam state has taken initiative under the scheme of Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanisation (SMAM).

Under this scheme, it has been proposed to established Village Level farm Machinery Bank (VLFMB), Custom Hiring Centres (CHC) and High Tech Hubs (HTH) in order to facilitate easy availability of farm implements and machineries for hiring by farmers.

- Fragmented and un-irrigated land holdings are the major impediments in tractor financing in the district. Around 89% land holding in the district are 2 hectare or less in size. Financing of tractor and power tiller in group mode (SHGs, JLGs, FPCs, etc.) may be beneficial.
- There are about 2212 tractors and about 2400 Power tillers in the district. The District Agriculture Office (Engg. Wing) provides training and demonstration services to farmers on use of farm machineries. Facilities for repairing at village / block level are inadequate.
- Agricultural Machinery is available at subsidised rates under various programmes like NFSM, SMAM, CMSGUY, VLFMB, etc.
- Agricultural Engineering wing in the District Agriculture Office is the nodal agency for all matters related to agricultural mechanization.
- Sufficient number of farm machinery & spare part dealers and service centres are available in the district.
- Govt of Assam has given priority to farm mechanisation under Chief Minister's Samagra Gramya Unnayan Yojana. Under the scheme Tractor is provided to a group of farmers in each villages of the State with 70% Subsidy (max Rs.5.50 lakh) by Govt. of Assam. Agriculture Deptt is the Nodal Agency for overseeing implementation of the scheme.

2.1.3.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25

Depending upon the present level of mechanization in the district, trend of credit flow under the sector, supportive policies framed for commercialization of agriculture, rising demand for agricultural equipment/ implements and revision in unit cost, the projection under the sector has been assessed as detailed below:

(Rs. in lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Tractor with accessories and trailer (30 - 35 HP)	7.467	200	1493.46	1194.76
ii	Power Tiller with Trailer and CMVR Kit (12 - 15 HP)	2.780	300	834.00	667.20
iii	Thresher (Single purpose) - Tractor mounted	1.350	0	0.00	0.00
iv	Reaper (Self-propelled)	1.350	120	162.00	162.00
v	Tractor with accessories and trailer (35 - 40 HP)	8.191	155	1269.59	1015.66
vi	Rotavator (Tractor Mounted)	1.050	190	199.50	199.50
	Sub-Total		**965**	**3958.54**	**3239.12**

Bank Loan: Unit Cost up to Rs.1.60 lakh (100%) and above Rs.1.60 (80% /90% of TFO)

The Block-wise and activity-wise potential assessed for the year 2024-25 is indicated in Annexure-I.

The potential for tractors and power tillers have been assessed on the basis of irrigated and un-irrigated cultivable area in the district, population of tractors and power tillers and the replacement demand.

2.1.4 Plantation and Horticulture including Sericulture

2.1.4.1 Status of the Sector in the district

Horticulture provides an impetus to commercialization of Agriculture. It fosters additional employment opportunities by gearing up the food processing sector. There is good scope for plantation and horticulture crops in the district due to suitable agro-climatic condition. Banana, Orange, Pineapple, Banana, Papaya, Jack fruit, Guava, Mango etc., are the major crops grown. Plantation crops include Arecanut & Coconut besides Tea and Rubber grown commercially. Major spices include Ginger, turmeric, Green chilli and others including Black pepper and Coriander.

Crops	2021-22 & 2022-23		
	Area (ha)	Production (MT)	Productivity (Kg/ha)
Pineapple	120	2126	17720
Papaya	230	2971	12920
Banana	1626	23821	14650
Orange	36	387	10756
Coconut	588	4096	54
Areca nut	1540	788	72
Assam Lemon	357	1830	5126
Guava	216	3724	17240
Litchi	216	1896	8780
Jackfruit	1224	11946	9760
Mango	160	1320	8250
Other fruits	325	2908	8947
Sub Total	**6638**	**57813**	**114275**
Spices & Condiments			
Ginger	375	2917	7780
Turmeric	456	308	670
Black Pepper	35	59	1680
Coriander	2420	3460	1430
Chilli	980	877	895
Other Spices	301	235	784
Sub Total	**4567**	**7856**	**13239**

(Source: Provisional data provided by Dist Agriculture Office, Darrang)

Large scale cultivation of Mustard, Vegetables as well as good coverage of fruit plants provides good scope for Apiculture. Except for rainy season all other months are available for honey production. Honey has good demand in domestic and export market. Beekeeping is concentrated in Duni, Deomornoi/Dighirpar, Debananda-Hazarikapara, Bechimari area. There is a district office of KVIB and a training centre at Duni. Beekeeping has potential to be one of the most important enterprises giving incremental income to farm families. Making of Bee Boxes, Honey processing, processing of Bee Venom etc., are the downstream units possible from apiculture.

The ground level credit flow to the sector in last two years has been indicate below:

2020-21		2021-22	
No	**Amt. (Rs. lakh)**	**No**	**Amt. (Rs. lakh)**
65	182.37	97	370.10

SERICULTURE:

Sericulture is a traditional activity and has good scope. Rearing, reeling/spinning, weaving is all done at household level. Integrated systems of rearing to weaving can be seen in Balipota area

of the district. Sericulture provides self-employment to many in the district. Developing a brand identity for silk products of the area is a necessity.

2.1.4.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned & gaps

There is a Community Canning & Training Centre (CC&TC) run by Agriculture Deptt at their Mangaldai Office under the supervision of SDAO (Agri). The CC&TC is catering to the training need of SHGs and farmers engaged in fruit preservation/processing activity. There are few private nurseries in Ramhari, Kalaigaon and Sipajhar area, however, there is no Govt. nursery for supplying horticulture saplings.

Nursery		Green House	Shadenet
Govt.	Pvt.		
1 No (10 ha area) Habigaon Progeny Orchard, BTAD, Udalguri. (under management control of DAO, Darrang)	Big – 1; Small – 8	5	186

District Sericulture Office functions with the Assistant Director and staff at Mangaldoi. The Deptt., have one Sericulture farm (at Bangalagarh), 02 collective Mulberry Garden (Hirapara, Bhurargarh), 02 VGR (also used as Muga food plantation centre, at-- Punia & Lengeriajhar), One Eri Seed Grainage (Deomornoi), 02 Eri Concentration Centre (Mollapara, Kabikara), 01 Mulberry grainage (at Bangalagarh farm) and one Mulberry Reeling unit at Bangalagarh. Central Silk Board has one Research & Extension Centre at Mangaldai headed by Asst. Director.

Issues/ critical Gap in Horticulture and Plantation:

- Poor access to markets, extension services and credit
- Shortage of quality seeds and good quality planting materials
- Lack of post-harvest infrastructure. Huge post-harvest loss to the tune of 40% due to poor cold chain infrastructure. Unorganized marketing system affecting realization of basic cultivation cost by farmers.
- Price volatility and weak producers-industry linkage
- Lack of awareness on quality standards
- Slow progress in replanting and rejuvenation programme
- Poor socio-economic condition of the farmers for availing hi tech options like micro irrigation, protected cultivation etc.

2.1.4.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25:

The potential for various bankable economic activities in the district for the sector during the year 2024-25 is assessed as under:

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Banana (1.8 m X 1.8 m) – acre	1.001	370	370.51	370.51
ii	Coconut (Acre) - 7.5 m X 7.5m	0.964	210	202.40	202.40
iii	Arecanut (Acre) - 2.7 m X 2.7 m	0.778	245	190.69	190.69
iv	Papaya (1.8m X 1.8m)	1.487	77	114.47	114.47
v	Assam Lemon	0.737	115	84.70	84.70

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
vii	Oyster Mushroom in House Hold system	0.468	80	37.42	37.42
viii	Pineapple Cultivation (Acre) - 90cm x 30cm x 60cm	2.227	59	131.39	105.13
ix	Mulberry Plantation (Acre)	0.600	170	102.00	102.00
x	Water Melon	1.733	59	102.25	81.80
xi	Musk Melon	1.561	42	65.54	65.54
xii	Eri pvt grandeur	2.784	75	208.80	167.04
xiii	Strawberry cultivation	4.735	14	66.29	53.03
xiv	Apiculture	0.070	750	52.50	52.50
xv	Floriculture - Marigold (45 cm x 40 cm)	1.332	30	39.35	39.35
	Sub-Total		**2296**	**1463.95**	**1463.95**

Bank Loan: Unit Cost up to Rs.1.60 lakh (100%) and above Rs.1.60 (80% /90% of TFO)

The Block-wise and crop-wise potential assessed for the year 2024-25 is indicated in Annexure-I

2.1.5 Forestry and Waste Land Development

2.1.5.1 Status of the sector in the district

Assam, the "Biological Gateway" of North East has recorded Forest Area (RFA) as 26,836 sq km which is 34.21% of Total Geographical Area (TGA) of State. Out of total recorded forest area, total reserved forest area of the state is 17,864 square km. and Un-classed State forest constitutes 8,972 square km. Based on India State of Forest Report 2021, the Forest Cover in the State is 28,312 sq km which is 36.09 % of the State's geographical area. Forest Cover in the State has decreased marginally by 15 sq km as compared to the previous assessment reported in ISFR 2019. The forest cover of the state has been indicated in the table below.

Status of Forest in Assam (sq. km)	
Total Geographical area	78,438
Very Dense Forest (VDF)	3017
Moderately Dense Forest (MDF)	9991
Open Forest (OF)	15304
Total Forest Cover	28312
% of Total Forest in State as against Geographical area	36.09%

(Source: State of Forest Report 2021)

There are about 9802 ha of fallow land and 3508 ha of cultivable wasteland. The area under forest including social forestry is 7927 ha, which is 5.00% of total geographical area of the district (Statistical Handbook 2021). There is an urgent need to increase the area under forest by way of protective afforestation of fallow and waste land by way of farm forestry and social forestry.

There is potential for Kadam plantation as it is used in plywood, match factory, pulpwood besides as wood in house building. Bamboo is a forestry species of short duration, which has lot of commercial importance and is grown in the district in a large scale.

2.1.5.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps:

Divisional Office of Social Forestry at Mangaldai has its own nurseries for raising saplings of various exotic as well as indigenous forestry species.

Need for bamboo- the Dhula-Kharupetia-Bechimari area of the district is known for Vegetable production. Bamboo is required in very high quantity for vegetables like Gourds, Parwal, etc. for erecting chang / machan. Price of bamboo in the area is also high. Special thrust for bamboo plantation in the area is an immediate necessity.

2.1.5.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25 :

(₹ lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Bamboo Cultivation (5 x 5)	0.704	21	14.78	14.78
ii	Teak cultivation (2 x 2)	1.958	24	46.99	37.58
iii	Bamboo Cultivation (Rhizome)	0.880	67	58.96	58.96
	Sub-Total		**112**	**120.73**	**111.32**

Bank Loan : Unit Cost up to Rs.1.60 lakh (100%) and above Rs.1.60 (80% of TFO)

The Block-wise and activity-wise potential assessed for the year 2024-25 is indicated in Annexure-I.

2.1.6 Animal Husbandry – Dairy

2.1.6.1 Status of the sector in the district

State	Cattle	Buffalo	Sheep	Goat	Pigs	Total
Darrang	457426	37070	35088	161879	21665	713128

(Source – Statistical Handbook Assam – 2022)

Dairy is emerging as an important avenue for income generation and employment opportunity in rural areas in the district. Agro-climatic condition in the district is suitable to support cross bred animals. In the district rural milk trade practices are not established and milk marketing network is not much developed and milk is produced mostly for household consumption and local marketing. There is scope for cooperative development and milk route development through institutional arrangements with milk processing plant. Rearing milch animals has traditionally been specific to certain communities/groups in a few pockets viz. Patharighat and Kuruwa in Sipajhar Block, Dalgaon Sialmari Block, parts of Pachim Mangaldai Block, parts of Bechimari Block and parts of Kalaigaon Block. As per the 20th Quinquennial Livestock Census 2019 the milch cattle and buffalo population in district during the year 2019-20 was 457426 and 37070, respectively. Cross bred cattle (Jersey x local) in the district, constitutes a negligible proportion of the total cattle population and formed 3.3% of the cattle population. The buffaloes in Assam are mostly of swamp type and yielded (Average 3.43 kg/day/animal). The native cattle are of small frame, low height and produces less than 2-5 kg of milk per day (Average 1.02 kg/day/animal as per GoI, DAHD, Basic animal husbandry statistics 2019). The inter-calving period is as high as 24 months and Age at Maturity more than 3-4 years.

2.1.6.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps:

The Department of Veterinary& Animal Husbandry is providing health cover, Artificial Insemination (AI) facilities and extension services. There are 03 block Veterinary dispensary, 1 state veterinary hospital, 8 dispenceries, 12 veterinary sub-centre , 01 Regional AI Centre, 01 vocational training centre (Dalgaon) and 1 frozen semen centre. There is one Disease Diagnosis lab in

Mangaldai, which is currently non-functional. Good quality milch animals and in particular Cross Bred (CB) Cows are not available in adequate numbers in the district. Dispensaries are not well equipped. Artificial Insemination (AI) facilities are available in the veterinary dispensary and required inputs for AI (frozen semen and liquid nitrogen) are procured from Tezpur/Guwahati. During 2021-22, 27,577 animals were artificially inseminated.

F.M.Cs/SHGs are involved in creating awareness about AI and disadvantage of natural service with local bull, health care, scientific calf rearing system, feeding management, role of castration, promotion of stall feeding, & fodder cultivation etc. There are 5 cattle markets in the district. Vaccination against Foot & Mouth disease, Brucella, HS, BQ, and swine fever etc. is being carried across veterinary centres, with 64208 animals vaccinated during 2021-22

There is no organised procurement of milk. The milk chilling plant at Kharupetia is not operational. One Bulk cooler has been installed by DRDA-Darrang at Patharighat for "Patharughat Dugdha Utpadak Samiti". Another BMC of 2000 Ltr capacity has been installed at Godhan Gopal outlet at Mangaldai. Purabi dairy has installed a BMC of 2000lt capacity in Ondulajhar GP during 2021-22. The district has 54 Dairy/Milk Cooperative Societies (DCS) and many of which are defunct. There are 24 trained Gopal Mitras in the district. The District produced 91,03,221 litres of milk in 2021-22 averaging around 24940 ltr milk / day

(Source: Dist. AH & Vety Officer, Darrang).

2.1.6.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25

Thrust is given to graduate dairy farmers into dairy entrepreneurs and thus organised units of mini dairy have been projected. Keeping in view the availability of good quality animals for bank finance, improvement in the availability of dry fodder / green fodder / feed and veterinary and milk marketing infrastructure the projection of the sector for the year 2024-25 was revised/modified as given below:

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
	TERM LOAN				
i	Crossbred Cows yielding 10 Ltrs of Milk (1+1) with New Shed	2.770	140	387.80	349.03
ii	Crossbred Cows yielding 8 Ltrs of Milk (1+1) with New Shed	2.346	180	422.28	380.06
iii	Two Buffaloes unit yielding 6 liters per day (1+1) with New shed	2.346	195	457.47	411.72
iv	Mini Dairy - 12 Ltrs (5 + 5 animals)	17.050	8	136.40	122.78
v	Bulk Milk cooling Unit (2000 Ltr. Capacity)	9.350	10	93.50	84.16
vi	Dairy processing equipment to produce Indigenous milk products	14.520	5	72.60	65.35
vii	Calf rearing (10 heifer calves)	3.200	45	144.00	133.65
viii	Dairy marketing outlet / parlour	2.200	23	50.60	45.54
	Term Loan Sub-Total		**606**	**2220.05**	**1592.29**
	WORKING CAPITAL				
ix	Working Capital for Dairy (KCC) - Small Dairy (1+1)	1.438	515	**740.55**	**740.55**
x	Working Capital for Dairy (KCC) - Medium Dairy (3+2)	1.565	135	**211.21**	**211.21**
xi	Working Capital for Dairy (KCC) - Commercial Dairy (5+5)	9.083	8	**72.66**	**72.66**

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
	Sub-Total Bank Loan (Working Capital - KCC)		**658**	**1024.42**	**1024.42**
	Total Animal Husbandry – Dairy		**1264**	**3244.47**	**2616.71**

Bank Loan: Unit Cost up to Rs.1.60 lakh (100%) and above Rs.1.60 (80% /90% of TFO)

The Block-wise, Activity-wise projections for 2024-25 are indicated in Annexure-I.

2.1.7 Animal Husbandry – Poultry

2.1.7.1 Status of the sector in the district

As per the 20th Livestock Census, 2019, poultry population in the district was 770404. As per estimates of the Dept. of AH & Veterinary, the annual production of eggs in the District is 138.58 lakh. Requirement of egg as per WHO norms (180 eggs per head per year) is 1671.30 lakh per year i.e., only 8.29% of the requirement is met by present level of production. This gives an indication of the potential available in this sector. Further, there is an industrial demand of 1.50 lakh egg / day in the Britannia Cake manufacturing unit at Mangaldai, which is presently sourced from AP and TN.

Ducks of three types are available in Assam viz., (i) **Egg type-** Nageswari (Assam local), Pati (Assam local), Rouben Chamballi (Kerala local), Chara (Kerala local) & Khaki Campbell X Pati cross bred. (ii) **Meat type-**Cina hah (local type) & White Pekin (exotic) and (iii) **Dual purpose -** Pati (Assam local).

The GLC flow vis a vis GLC outstanding for last two years is indicated below:

(Rs Lakh)

2020-21		2021-22	
Disbursed	**Outstanding**	**Disbursed**	**Outstanding**
25.79	230.45	51.58	170.92

2.1.7.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps

For health cover, infrastructure available for dairy is common to poultry as well. Department has one Duck-cum-fishery farm at Sipajhar and one Poultry demonstration unit at Mangaldai. The hatchery at Sipajhar to supply Day old chicks (DOC) was made operational with DRDA funds. Cost of DOCs procured from Guwahati is high. Establishment of a hatchery is a necessity for the district. There is good demand for eggs & broilers. Demand for Egg is met with imports from AP and TN. A few poultry farmers have been operating their units successfully. Poultry feed is available from Guwahati & also locally produced (by Sanjukta feeds). However, insufficient availability of feed & higher cost of feed is a major constraint. Of late demand for local chicken has gone up.

Training facilities for poultry farmers is not adequate. The department has no Poultry farm in the district. Training is given by Assam Livestock and Poultry Development Corporation at Khanapara.. SIPRD provides training as well as ducklings to SHGs under the Special Project of SGSY.

- Supply of improved variety of Ducks will boost egg production since every household rears at least a few ducks.
- As reported Govt. Duck-cum-Fish Farm at Sipajhar has procured a new hatchery unit having capacity to hatch 5000 eggs and the same has been operationalised.

2.1.7.3 Assessment of potential for the financial year 2024-25

The demand for credit is for expansion/creation of units as well as setting up of breeding infrastructure. Taking into consideration the availability of infrastructure and support services, the PLP projections for 2024-25 as assessed as under:

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
	TERM LOAN				
i	Hybrid Broiler (1000 birds unit)	4.727	215	1016.31	813.05
ii	Hybrid Layer (5000 birds unit)	58.791	7	411.54	329.22
iii	Duck Farming (28 F + 4 M Unit)	0.320	1225	392.00	392.00
iv	Duck Farming (100 F + 15 M Unit)	1.127	25	28.18	28.18
	Term Loan Sub-Total		**1472**	**1848.02**	**1562.45**
	WORKING CAPITAL				
vi	KCC (Working Capital) - Broiler Firm 1000 birds all in all out	1.68	215	**362.06**	**362.06**
vii	KCC (Working Capital) - Broiler Firm 5000 birds all in all out	8.66	30	**259.80**	**259.80**
viii	KCC (Working Capital) - Layer Unit 5000 birds (1:1:3 -cage system)	20.818	7	**145.74**	**145.74**
	Sub-Total		**252**	**767.60**	**767.60**
	Total Animal Husbandry – Poultry		**1724**	**2615.62**	**2330.05**

Bank Loan: Unit Cost up to Rs.1.60 lakh (100%) and above Rs.1.60 (80% /90% of TFO)

The Block-wise, Activity-wise projections for 2024-25 are indicated in Annexure-I.

2.1.8 Animal Husbandry – Sheep, Goat, Piggery, etc.

2.1.8.1 Status of the sector in the district

Goatery and Piggery have good potential in the district and production as well as demand for chevron and pork is high. There is also a huge demand for mutton and pork in the neighbouring district Goat rearing has tremendous potential as a low cost venture for SHGs. As per Assam Statistical Handbook 2022, there are 35088 sheep; 161879 goats; and 21665 pigs the District. The total meat production in the district (inc. fowls) is 36640kg/day (Source: Dept. of Animal Husbandry and Veterinary)

2.1.8.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps:

Veterinary infrastructure for Dairy is applicable for goat and pig rearing also. There is shortage of Pig breeding units and piglets are to be procured from outside. Availability of good breeding stock for establishing pig breeding farm should be ensured. Organised Goat farming needs to be promoted. Establishment of slaughter house, meat processing units etc. may be taken up.

2.1.8.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25 :

In view of the demand and the infrastructure available and expected, the exploitable potential is assessed as under:

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
	TERM LOAN				
i	Goat Rearing (10 F+1 M) - Black Bengal/Assam Hill Goat with new shed	1.013	245	**248.19**	**248.19**
ii	Goat Rearing (10 F+1 M) - Cross Bred/Upgraded Sirohi Beetal with new shed	1.592	190	**302.48**	**302.48**
iii	Pig rearing & fattening Units - Crossbred Sows and Exotic Boar (3 F + 1 M)	2.252	170	**382.84**	**306.28**
iv	Piggery – Breeding unit (20F+4M)	14.512	13	**188.65**	**150.93**
v	Goat Rearing (20 F+1 M) - Black Bengal/Assam Hill Goat with new shed	3.613	53	**191.489**	**153.17**
	Term Loan Total		**671**	**1313.65**	**1161.05**
	WORKING CAPITAL				
Vi	KCC for Goat rearing & breeding unit (10+1)	0.605	435	**263.32**	**263.32**
vii	KCC for Goat rearing & breeding unit (20+1)	1.080	53	**57.23**	**57.23**
viii	KCC for Pig Breeding cum fattener unit (3+1)	0.549	170	**93.40**	**93.40**
ix	KCC for Pig Breeding cum fattener unit (20+4)	3.829	13	**49.78**	**39.82**
	Sub-Total		**671**	**463.73**	**453.77**
	Total Animal Husbandry - Sheep/Goat & Piggery		**1342**	**1777.38**	**1614.82**

Bank Loan: Unit Cost up to Rs.1.60 lakh (100%) and above Rs.1.60 (80% /90% of TFO)

The Block-wise, Activity-wise projections for 2024-25 are indicated in Annexure-I.

2.1.9 Fisheries

2.1.9.1 Status of the sector in the district

Fisheries sector has an important role in supply of animal protein and socio-economic development. The district is endowed with vast resources as ponds, tanks, beels, derelict water bodies and riverine sources.

Beels		Ponds & Tanks		Derelict water bodies / swamps		River Fisheries	
Nos.	Area (ha)	Nos.	Area (ha)	Nos.	Area (ha)	Nos.	Area (ha)
19	4020	33159	4117.92	71	610	17	495.25

(Source: Statistical Handbook 2022, District Fisheries Office).

Against a domestic production of 13918.21 MT, the district has a requirement of around 12084 MT. The total fish imported during 2021-22 was 137.99 MT. Around 500 farmers were imparted training by the Deptt. during 2021-22. There are 15 eco hatcheries in the district with a total production 137.5 million seed. The fisherman population in the district is estimated to be 2195. (Source: District Fisheries Office & Assam Statistical Handbook 2022).

The GLC flow vis a vis GLC outstanding for last two years is indicated below:

(Rs Lakh)

2020-21		2021-22	
Disbursed	**Outstanding**	**Disbursed**	**Outstanding**
25.79	213.47	51.58	200.26

2.1.9.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps:

District Fishery Development Office is the nodal agency for development of fisheries in the district. They provide financial, technical and extension services /training etc. to the fish farmers. There are 12 hatcheries of which 11 are in private sector. Lakhimpur Meen Mahal Unnayan Samiti has developed a model fisheries pond in Lakhimpur village. There are 20 registered fish market in the district and one newly constructed fish market is awaiting allocation by the Municipal Board. There are 55 nos. of Hapa Breeder, 55 nos. of fish seed grower, 32 nos. of fish seed trader and 14 active Fisheries co-operative societies in the district.

The district is not self-sufficient in fish seed (fry and fingerlings) production and depends largely on imports from neighbouring districts., however the position of fish seed production is increasing year on year to bridge the gap. In connection with fish seed production,the District produced 90.30 million of fish spawn, 36.31 million of fry and 10.89 million of fingerling during 2020-21. There is one private ornamental fish dealer in the District. There is a Magur breeding hatchery at Dighirpar which however remains defunct for a long time. Moreover, there are 3 other farmers producing seed through HAPA breeding. Off late few progressive fish farmers are pioneering tank culture of Magur and Kutchia in the District along with Re-Circulatory Aquaculture System (RAS). Fishery is being promoted in the District under various programmes, viz., RKVY, APART, AACP, NFDB, Blue Revolution etc. The “Matsya Mitras” provide necessary service to the farmers of their area. There is however no Fish Feed Mill/Plant in the district. Under CMSGUY , 1 unit of Cage Culture in Open Water Bodies at Rowmari Beel has been granted assistance. Under Ghare Ghare Pukhuri Ghare Ghare Maach scheme, 253 individual ponds and 10 community structures covering a total of 55 ha were supported under RIDF-XXIII in Darrang.

NABARD has promoted a FPO of fish farmers in Dighirpar – Barangabari area. The FPO has started its operation and mobilized a large number of fish farmers. The FPO has opened their sales outlet at Dighirpar market.

2.1.9.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25:

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Traditional fish culture in existing water bodies	1.023	700	716.10	716.10
ii	Fish culture in existing water bodies (0.3 m excavation)	0.760	470	357.06	357.06
iii	Fish culture in existing water bodies (0.5 m excavation)	1.023	215	219.92	219.90
iv	Fish Seed rearing in 3 Nurseries (20m x 10m x 1m) Nos.	1.325	145	192.13	192.13
v	Semi- intensive fish culture with high stocking and multiple harvesting (1 m excavation)	2.200	30	66.00	52.80
	Term Loan Total		**1560**	**1551.20**	**1537.99**

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
	Working Capital				
i	Working Capital (KCC) - Traditional fish culture in existing water bodies	0.464	700	325.07	325.08
ii	Working Capital (KCC) : Fish Seed rearing in nurseries (3 nursery ponds of 200 sqm area each)	0.382	145	55.45	55.47
iii	Working Capital (KCC) : Integrated Fish Culture with poultry	1.798	220	395.56	395.56
	Sub-Total		**1065**	**776.07**	**776.11**
	Total Fishery		**2625**	**2327.27**	**2314.10**

Bank Loan: Unit Cost up to Rs.1.60 lakh (100%) and above Rs.1.60 (80% /90% of TFO).

The Block-wise, Activity-wise projections for 2024-25 are indicated in Annexure-I. As per RBI guideline 8% of bank loan should flow to SF/MF.

2.1.10 Farm Credit – Others including Two Wheelers for Farmers

2.1.10.1 Status of the sector in the district

Bullocks constitute the biggest source of draught power. The district is predominantly agrarian in nature and due to large number of small holdings, mechanisation of farm activities is limited. Since ploughing is crucial in farming operations it is important that farmers own bullocks and carts for their agricultural operations and transportation. Since credit for Plough Bullock & Animal Carts have almost stopped, SHGs members who cannot afford anything but the Bullock avail credit from SHGs for purchase of Plough Bullock etc.

Providing two wheelers to farmers for commuting between home, farm and market is now considered as a farm activity that can be financed by banks. The acquisition of two wheelers by farmers has helped increase their mobility and saved their valuable time on travel and reduced the cost of travelling.

2.1.10.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps:

Infrastructure indicated in the other AH chapters is applicable. Cart is made locally with bamboo, wood and carpenters are available in the district. There are 5 cattle markets in the district where bullocks are sold and purchased. However, the markets are not regulated.

2.1.10.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25

(Rs. in lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Two wheeler	0.700	36	25.20	25.20
ii	Bullock Carts	0.700	12	8.40	8.40
iii	Bullocks (2 Bullocks)	0.600	32	19.20	19.20
	Sub-Total		**80**	**52.80**	**52.80**

Bank Loan: Unit Cost up to Rs.1.60 lakh (100% of TFO)

The Block-wise and activity-wise potential assessed for the year 2024-45 indicated in Annexure-I.

2.1.10.4 Other related matters

Crop production is one sector which is affected to a large extent by the influences of climate change. Availability of inputs, change of seasonality, sudden occurrence of cyclones, post-harvest losses are some of the critical issues which will affect the farmers' incomes. Some of the issues are being addressed at various levels and many need to be taken care of.

2.1.11 Sustainable Agriculture Practice

2.1.11.1 Status of the sector in the district

The operational farm holding in India is declining and practically there is no scope for horizontal expansion of land for agriculture due to the ever-increasing population and decline in per capita availability of land in the country. Integrated farming system (IFS) is the sustainable development in agriculture with efficient soil, water, crop and pest management practices, which are environmentally friendly and cost-effective. In IFS, Crop may have subsystem like mono-crop, mixed/intercrop, multi-tier crops of cereals, legumes (pulses), oilseeds, forage etc. Livestock components may be milch cow, goat, sheep, duck, poultry, pig, bees etc. Tree components may include timber, fuel, fodder and fruit trees.

Integrated Farming System (IFS) and its component:

- Integrated Farming Systems (IFS) approach stabilizes income streams through natural resource management and livelihood diversification.
- An example of integrated farming could be fish and livestock cultivation along with general farming practices which support each other.
- In IFS, the waste of one enterprise becomes the input of another for making better use of resources.
- In the integrated crop-livestock farming system, crop residues can be used for animal feed, while manure from livestock can enhance agricultural productivity.

2.1.11.2 Steps for up-scaling science-based integrated farming systems:

- Large scale spread of IFS concept through Capacity building of stakeholders including skill development.
- Initiation of National Mission on Integrated Systems by converging schemes of crops, horticulture, livestock, fisheries etc.
- Focus on market-oriented diversification and livelihood improvement
- Crop and forage rotation
- Integrate less land requiring activities.

2.1.11.3. Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25

Taking into account the above, the potential for the year 2024-25 is estimated and is presented in Table given below:

(Rs. in lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Integrated Fish + Duck + Horticulture Farming	1.437	21	30.17	30.17
ii	Poultry + Fish+ Corn System	0.776	35	27.17	27.16
iii	Paddy + Toria culture with Apiculture	0.493	65	32.06	32.06
iv	Paddy + Vegetable+ Mushroom Cultivation+ Vermi Compost	0.928	33	30.62	30.62
v	Integrated pisiculture with Duckery -10 Nos (Bigha)	1.177	180	211.86	211.87

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
vi	Integrated pisiculture with Piggery- 4 Nos	2.056	159	326.90	261.53
vii	Working Capital : Integrated Fish Culture with duck rearing	0.243	180	43.66	43.66
viii	Working Capital: Integrated Fish Culture with piggery	0.455	74	33.65	33.65
	TOTAL		**747**	**736.09**	**670.72**

Bank Loan: Unit Cost up to Rs.1.60 lakh (100% of TFO), > Rs.1.6 Lakh (80% of TFO)

2.2. Agriculture Infrastructure

2.2.1. Construction of Storage Facilities, Warehouses, Market Yards, Godowns, Silos, Cold Storage Units/ Cold Storage Chains

2.2.1.1 Status of the sector in the district

Construction of storage facility is essential for ensuring timely and adequate supply of inputs and providing storage facilities for farmers to enable them to avoid loss due to wastage and distress sale of produce. There is a shortage of storage space in the district

Storage capacity for the purpose of storing agricultural produce of the farmers is needed to the extent of 30% of the total production in the district. It is estimated that storage capacity of about 65,000 MT is required for food grains including oilseeds. To store perishable items like fruits & vegetables, cold storage facility to the extent of about 50,000 MT is required. There are no Cold Storage facilities for vegetables, Potato, Fruits etc. Storage facilities available with FCI, JCI and State Government to store food grains, oilseeds and jute is inadequate. There is only one regulated market in the district at Kharupetia and one fruit & vegetable preservation training centre (Community Canning & Training Centre) at Mangaldoi.

2.2.1.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps:

- The storage facility available in the district is only 18650 MT under Govt. sector (Assam State Warehousing Corporation) against the requirement of estimated storage capacity of 65000 MT for food grains including oilseeds [excluding vegetables & fruits].
- There are 8 Rural Godowns in the District having a total installed capacity of 18,650 MT constructed under GoI sponsored 'Gramin Bhandaran Yojana/ISAM'.
- NABARD has sanctioned Rs.100.00 lakh under RIDF-XVIII for construction of five warehouse of 500 MT each in five PACS.
- NABARD has sanctioned Rs.2488.45 lakh under RIDF-XX-Warehouse Infrastructure Fund for construction of a 5000 MT Cold Storage at Kharupetia by ASAMB.
- Construction of a Vegetable Processing Unit under RIDF-XV at Dalgaon with a total project cost of Rs.590.00 lakh is complete and awaiting operationalization by AIIDC.
- There is an Agri Marketing Infrastructure project in Kharupetia supported under GoI scheme of ISAM.
- Local entrepreneurship and risk taking capacity are limiting factors. Besides, farming community is not habituated to store fruits and vegetables by paying hire charges.

Government of India has launched Agricultural Infrastructure Fund wherein financing facility of Rs.1,00,000.00 crore has been earmarked for funding Agricultural Infrastructure at farm gate and aggregation points with an emphasis on financially viable post-harvest management infrastructure. The scheme envisages credit guarantee to the banks under CGTMSE and 3% interest subvention for loans up-to Rs.2.0 cr. Under proposed Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF) scheme, PACS have been included as one of the eligible institutions for Interest

Subvention for establishing decentralized farm-gate Post Harvest Management Infrastructure. It is proposed to saturate all the potential PACS for conversion as Multi Service Centres over a period of three years commencing from FY 2020-21 and special refinance facility will be provided to eligible PACS through StCB at rate of interest not more than 4%.

Even though there is potential for setting up of new Cold Storage, erratic power supply situation in the district dissuades entrepreneur to establish cold storage/cold chain. However, there is no granular data available of credit flow to this sector. The GLC flow to the sector in last two years have been indicated below:

2020-21		2021-22	
No	**Amt. (Rs. lakh)**	**No**	**Amt. (Rs. lakh)**
165	134.67	104	152.18

2.2.1.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25:

(Rs. in lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Cold Storage (1000 MT)	100.000	9	**900.00**	**720.00**
ii	Rural Godown (1000 MT)	30.000	7	**210.00**	**168.00**
iii	Market Yard	13.500	5	**67.50**	**54.00**
	Sub-Total		**21**	**1177.50**	**942.00**

Bank Loan: 80% of Total financial Outlay

The Block-wise and activity-wise potential assessed for the year 2024-25 is indicated in Annexure-I.

2.2.2 Land Development, Soil Conservation and Watershed Development

2.2.2.1 Status of the sector in the district

Darrang is endowed with fertile land and abundant water resources offering good scope for agricultural operations. The economy of Darrang is predominantly agricultural based, as about 85% of the populations directly or indirectly depend on agriculture and allied activities for their livelihood. Conservation of soil and water is crucial for increasing crop production, productivity, food and sustainable livelihood security in rural areas particularly now in the context of emerging problem of climate change.

Darrang district with abundant rainfall measuring 1720.7 mm per annum spreading over 6-7 months offer considerable scope for land development activities. The land use pattern suggests that there are 33513 ha of land not available for cultivation, 3508 ha of cultivable waste land, 9802 ha of current fallow land, and 595 ha of water logged land which can be brought under cultivation with suitable land and water management measures. Besides, vast scope exists for land development by way of removing silt and sand deposited during flash flood in rainy season.

There is no data available on credit flow to this sector. However, there exists a good banking scope for on farm developments and water harvest tanks.

2.2.2.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned & gaps:

Land Development works are looked after by Engineering wing of District Agriculture Office, Mangaldai and works relating to soil conservation is supervised by Divisional Soil Conservation Office, Mangaldai and Project Office, Mangaldai. Engineering wing of District Agriculture Office, Mangaldai undertakes reclamation of cultivable wasteland, leveling of agricultural lands, flood affected area etc.

2.2.2.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	OFD Work (1 Ha : 100m x 100m)	0.155	240	37.20	37.20
ii	Farm Pond (10m x 10m x 3m))	0.250	375	93.75	93.75
iii	NADEP Compost (3m x 2m x 1m)	0.140	225	31.50	31.50
iv	Vermi compost (3m x 2m x 1m)	0.210	490	102.90	102.90
v	Homestead Farming	0.440	325	143.00	143.00
	Sub-Total		**1655**	**408.35**	**408.35**

Bank loan is taken as 100% of the financial outlay

The Block-wise exploitable potential assessed for the year 2024-25 is indicated in Annexure-I.

2.2.3: Agriculture Infrastructure - Others

2.2.3.1 Status of the sector in the district

As per the revised guidelines for priority sector lending a separate classification for loans, meant for plant tissue culture and agri-biotechnology, seed production, production of bio-pesticides, bio-fertilizer and vermi - composting, was created as “Others” under the broad classification of agriculture infrastructure.

Seed production and vermicomposting have good potential in the district. There is a good scope of producing foundation seed in the district which will enhance the income of farmers in the district who otherwise produce food grains only as price of the certified seeds are more remunerative.

Credit flow under the sector has got momentum during 2019-20, however, the performance of the banks is not encouraging during the last two years. The decrease in the trend credit flow may be due to COVID-19 pandemic/lockdown etc. Further analysis on the sector is challenging due to unavailability of granular data.

2.2.3.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gap

The KVK is actively involved in FLD and OFT activities and is extending help and creating awareness regarding vermicompost and seed production.

- There is a further need to involve community in these activities through farmer clubs, FPOs, NGOs, SHGs, etc.
- There is a need for awareness creation for organic fertilizers.
- Lot of extension work is needed so that dependence on chemical fertilizers is lessened.
- Exposure visits need to be tailor made and organised for these two activities.

2.2.3.3 Assessment of Credit Potential for the financial year 2024-25:

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Seed Production and Processing	12.000	14	168.00	134.40
ii	Biofertiliser Unit (150 TPA)	12.000	3	36.00	28.80
	Sub-Total		**17**	**204.00**	**163.20**

Bank Loan @ 80% of Total Financial Outlay.

The Block-wise exploitable potential assessed for the year 2024-45 is indicated in Annexure-I.

2.3. Agriculture – ancillary activities

2.3.1 Food and Agro Processing

2.3.1.1 Status of the sector in the district

Recognizing the enormous benefits that the food processing industry can bring to agriculture and job creation, and to consumers, food processing is treated as a priority sector for bank credit. As part of its efforts to give an impetus to the Agro & Food Processing Sector the Govt. of India has set up Food Processing Fund during 2014-15 in NABARD for providing direct loans to public and private sector enterprise preferably being set up in Mega Food Park.

NABARD has also initiated efforts to promote the sector by offering facility of refinance, development of model schemes, ensuring proper implementation of Central Sector schemes for Cold storage, Rural Godown etc. Further, to facilitate self-employment in the sector NABARD provides training support in food processing under its Development Initiatives. One Food & Vegetable processing unit at Dalgaon has been constructed under RIDF XV and awaiting operationalization by AIIDC.

Venture Capital Support in the Food Processing sector is available from SFAC. Ministry of Food Processing, GOI provides training to encourage youths to take up self-employment.

Potential for Development in the district:

Agro based industries from Agriculture waste like paddy straw, paddy husk, rice bran etc., are feasible. A few Rice mills, oil expeller (mustard), poultry and cattle feed plants are feasible in the district. Huge quantities of surplus vegetable of the district can be profitably utilised for establishing a few preservation/processing centre. Two large scale processing units have been established by the Sanghi & Sanskar of the Nillon's group at the Industrial Infrastructure Development Centre of Govt. of Assam in Dalgaon. Arecanut is available & Supari making is a predominant activity in Kharupetia area. Solvent extraction plant from oil cake is feasible in the district.

At present, skins and hides available in the district are being sent outside. An unit to manufacture intermediate products from skins and hides will be viable.

2.3.1.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps:

- Infrastructure for establishing industries are available in the Industrial Centre at Mangaldoi and the Industrial Infrastructure Development Centre of Govt. of Assam at Dalgaon.
- Unavailability of 24 hrs power supply is one of the major constraints. Poor communication facilities & transportation bottlenecks are one of the major impeding factors.
- Scope for processing in the livestock/dairy/fishery sector may not be a practicable proposition unless production jumps manifold.
- Small centres as Common Facility Centre/ Training cum Production Centre etc. needs to be developed to encourage food processing in household/cottage industries sector. It would facilitate provision of employment opportunities especially self-employment.
- Infrastructure facilities for packaging, quality control (laboratory etc.) are a necessity.
- The bottling plant of Horlicks at Mangaldoi under SRD Group and the Sanghi & Sanskar units at Dalgaon are the major units. Rice Mills are existent in Kharupetia. The SRD group has large size bakery at Mangaldoi.
- One ORS manufacturing plant and One Britannia Cake manufacturing plant has been set up by the SRD group at Mangaldoi Industrial Centre.
- A biscuit manufacturing unit having a project outlay of Rs.200 crore has been set up by ITC Ltd., at Ramhari near Mangaldai in joint venture with SRD Group.

2.3.1.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25:

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Fruit preservation	1.500	100	150.00	120.00
ii	Rice mill Mordernisation	20.000	72	1440.00	1152.00
iii	Bakery/ confectionery	1.500	47	70.50	56.40
iv	Sauce/ jam/ ketchup	1.500	51	76.50	61.20
v	Coir Products	1.000	45	45.00	36.00
vi	Cattle Feed Mill	10.000	23	230.00	184.00
vii	M.Oil Mfg	10.000	77	770.00	616.00
	Sub-Total		**415**	**2782.00**	**2225.60**

Bank Loan is 80% of Financial Outlay

The Block-wise and Sector-wise potential assessed for the year 2024-25 is indicated in Annexure-I.

2.3.2: Agriculture – Ancillary Activities - Others

2.3.2.1 Status of the Sector in the district

The Ministry of Agriculture, Government of India, in association with NABARD has launched a unique programme to take better methods of farming to each and every farmer across the country. This programme aims to tap the expertise available in the large pool of Agriculture Graduates. Irrespective of whether one is a fresh graduate or not, one can set up one's own Agri Clinic and Agri Business Centre (ACABC) and offer professional extension services to farming community.

Thirdly, there are 21 PACS in the District however none of them are undertaking credit business. There is a banking potential exists for financing such PACS so that credit needs for its members are met.

In Darrang district NABARD's SHPI partners had promoted SHGs. Presently, NRLM is being implemented in two blocks (Dalgaon Sialmari and Pub Mangaldai) of the district by Assam Rural Livelihood Mission Society (ASRLMS) wherein formation of all women SHGs belonging to BPL family are in progress and is targeting to saturate the district.

2.3.2.2 Infrastructure and support available, planned and gaps:

- A data base at the district level is required to map the availability of agriculture graduates.
- Dedicated NGOs are required which may organised farmers for formation of FPOs.
- Audit of PACS need to be taken up regularly and on time.
- Awareness generation is needed for schemes like ACABC.
- Attitudinal change is required at banks' level for increased financing in such activities.
- Such sub sectors should also be reviewed in district level forum and meetings.

2.3.2.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25:

(Rs. lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Loans to PACS/ FSS/ LAMPS	10.000	17	170.00	136.00
ii	Loans to MFI for on-lending to agriculture	25.000	17	425.00	340.00
iii	PMJDY	0.100	1900	190.00	190.00
iv	Agriclinics/agri-business Centres	20.000	9	180.00	144.00
v	Loans to FPOs/FPCs	10.000	10	100.00	80.00
	Sub-Total		**1953**	**1065.00**	**890.00**

Bank Loan: Unit Cost up to Rs.*1.60 lakh (100%) and above* Rs.*1.60 (80% of TFO)*

The Block-wise and Sector-wise potential assessed for the year 2024-25 is indicated in Annexure-I.

CHAPTER - 3

CREDIT POTENTIAL FOR MICRO, SMALL AND MEDIUM ENTERPRISE (MSME)

3.1 Status of the sector in the district

Assam has made impressive strides over the years to carve out a niche for itself in the fields of small and micro enterprises. The state has been a leader in manufacture of a number of products like Handloom, Sericulture and handicrafts which also form a large part of the small and micro enterprises providing maximum employment with low investment.

The State Government has introduced many schemes for the benefit of MSME sector as a whole which includes infrastructure development, investment/power/transport subsidies, tax holidays and also industry specific incentives for tea tourism, bamboo etc. under Assam Ease of doing Business (Amendment Act), 2020 & Assam MSME (Facilitation of Establishment and Operation) Act, 2020.

Definition of MSME

The existing criterion of definition of MSMEs is based on the MSMED Act, 2006. However, from July 2020 over six crore micro, small and medium enterprises across the country has been classified on the basis of the new criteria approved by the government. Composite criteria, which have removed the discrimination between manufacturing and services components, has been used in the revised guidelines for categorization. The revised yardstick for categorization is as follows:

Particulars	Revised	
	Manufacturing Enterprises	Enterprises rendering Services
Enterprise	Investment in plant and machinery or equipment	Investment in equipment
Micro	Not more than Rs. 1.00 crore and annual turnover not more than Rs. 5.00 crore	Not more than Rs.1.00 crore and annual turnover not more than Rs. 5.00 crore
Small	Not more than Rs. 10 crore and Annual Turnover ; not more than Rs. 50 crore	Not more than Rs. 10 crore and Annual Turnover ; not more than Rs. 50 crore
Medium	Not more than Rs.50 crore and Annual Turnover ; not more than Rs. 250 crore	Not more than Rs. 50 crore and Annual Turnover ; not more than Rs. 250 crore

Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana under the Micro Units Development and Refinance Agency (MUDRA) Bank is a new instrument for the development and refinancing activities relating to micro units. Under the aegis of Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana, MUDRA has created its initial products / schemes. The interventions have been named 'Shishu', 'Kishor' and 'Tarun' according to the funding needs of the beneficiary micro unit /entrepreneur. Performance of MUDRA during the last three years in the district is as under:

(Rs.in Lakhs)

FY	Shishu		Kishore		Tarun	
	No	Amount	No	Amount	No	Amount
2022-23	17652	3610.49	18190	15605.35	1076	5765.80
2021-22	2221	761.31	2340	3414.72	333	2302.66
2020-21	5126	1672.15	4377	5180.98	274	1739.92

(Source – SLBC, LDM-Darrang)

3.1.2. Measures taken by RBI for improving flow of credit to MSME sector are as under:

i. **Priority Sector Lending Guidelines:** In terms of Master Direction on 'Priority Sector Lending (PSL) – Targets and Classification' dated September 4, 2020, all bank loans to MSMEs conforming to the conditions prescribed therein qualify for classification under priority sector lending.

ii. **Collateral requirements of MSME units:** Scheduled Commercial Banks have been mandated not to accept collateral security in the case of loans up to Rs.10 lakh extended to units in the MSE sector.

iii. **Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS):** In order to address the problem of delayed payments to MSMEs, RBI has issued guidelines for setting up and operating Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS). The scheme facilitates the financing of trade receivables of MSMEs from corporate and other buyers, including government departments and public sector undertakings (PSUs) through multiple financiers electronically.

iv. Several special frameworks have been introduced since 2019 to enable banks to restructure their MSME exposures, subject to certain conditions, to address the stress in the sector due to various factors. A special restructuring window was opened for MSMEs on January 01, 2019, which was extended vide notification dated February 11, 2020 and subsequently subsumed under the COVID Resolution Frameworks for MSMEs announced on August 06, 2020 and May 05, 2021.

In addition to the above, following measures have also been taken to provide credit to MSMEs:

- Rs.5 lakh crore Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS), for businesses including MSMEs.
- Credit Guarantee Scheme (CGS**):** Ministry of MSME has been operating Credit Guarantee Scheme for Micro & Small Enterprises through Credit Guarantee Fund Trust for Micro & Small Enterprises (CGTMSE) since July, 2000. Under this scheme upto 85% guarantee is extended upto credit facility of Rs.200 lakh, for both term loan and working capital. Budget 2023-24 announced the infusion of Rs.9,000 crore in the corpus of CGTMSE to enable an additional credit of Rs.2 lakh crore with reduced cost of the credit.
- Rs.50,000 crore equity infusion through Self Reliant India Fund.
- No global tenders for procurement up to Rs. 200 crore.
- "Udyam Registration" for MSMEs, for Ease of Doing Business w.e.f. 1.7.2020.
- Launching of an online Portal "Champions" in June, 2020 to cover many aspects of e-governance including grievance redress and handholding of MSMEs.
- Inclusion of Retail and Wholesale traders as MSMEs w.e.f. 2.7. 2021 for priority sector lending.
- Non-tax benefits extended for 3 years in case of an upward change in status of MSMEs.
- Launch of Udyam Assist Platform on 11.1.2023 to bring Informal Micro Enterprises under the formal ambit for availing the benefits under Priority Sector Lending.
- On the credit delivery front, the Digital Banking Units (DBUs) will provide end-to-end digital processing of small ticket retail and MSME loans, starting from online applications to disbursals. There are two DBUs in Baksa (SBI) and Bongaigaon (PNB) district.

3.1.3 Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY) is the flagship outcome based skill training scheme of the Ministry of Skill Development & Entrepreneurship (MSDE). The objective of this skill certification and reward scheme is to enable and mobilize youth to take up outcome based skill training and become employable and earn their livelihood. The Make in

India programme includes new initiatives designed to facilitate investment, foster innovation, protect intellectual property and build best-in-class manufacturing infrastructure. The Skill India programme will complement the Make in India programme.

3.1.4 Stand Up India

Stand Up India scheme facilitates bank loans between Rs.10.00 lakh and Rs.100.00 lakh to at least 01 SC/ST borrower and at least 01 women borrower per bank branch for setting up a greenfield enterprise. This enterprise may be in manufacturing, services or the trading sector. In case of non-individual enterprises, at least 51% of the shareholding and controlling stake should be held by either and SC/St or woman entrepreneur.

3.1.5 Other Govt. schemes and Interventions

- The GOI has recently announced the scheme 'PM Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises Scheme (PM-FME Scheme) under which 2,00,000 micro food processing units will be directly assisted with credit linked subsidy.
- Under Chief Minister's new plantation scheme, a financial grant of ₹ 5000 per bigha for plantation of tree sapling is provided. 141 Small Tea Growers has benefited under the scheme. During 2021-22, 40 beneficiaries were covered under ATISIS scheme with assistance of ₹ 72845199.
- Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF) has unique features of convergence with any other scheme of Central or State government for the eligible activities under AIF. The beneficiaries of other schemes can avail 3% additional interest subvention on top of benefits availed under other scheme in form of capital or interest subsidy. Convergence has so far been implemented in AIF portal for schemes like PMFME and PMKSY under Ministry of Food Processing Industries, National horticulture board, PMKUSUM under MoNRE, AC&ABC etc .
- Govt. of Assam has recently announced the Mukhya Mantri Sva-Niyojan Mission under which it is proposed to promote micro entrepreneurship among families below the poverty line and low income-households. Under the scheme, seed capital of two lakh rupees each will be given to one lakh beneficiaries. The sectors covered under the scheme will include manufacturing, food processing, and handicraft. A further one lakh youth entrepreneurs will be provided project-based subsidies. Government of Assam and SIDBI have also signed a Memorandum of Understanding for providing equity support, interest subvention, evaluation of potential infrastructure projects, facilitation of credit inflow into MSMEs. SIDBI has committed an amount of Rs.350 Cr. to support the initiative of State Government in development of several Primary Processing Centers and other industrial infrastructure. In tune with National Mission on Oilseeds & Oil Palm, State Govt. has proposed to establish Mini Oil Mills with packaging units envisaging support from Assam State Agricultural Marketing Board to market the products which will lead to oilseed cultivation under Mini Mission –I & II for development of cultivation of Oil Palm and tree borne oil seeds.

3.2 Infrastructure and linkage support available, planned and gaps:

The District Industries and Commerce Centre (DI&CC),Mangaldoi coordinates credit linked programme in Off Farm Sector. Besides DI&CC, Department of Handloom and Textiles, DRDA and KVIB are also engaged in promotion of Off Farm Sector. DI&CC assists in identification of suitable schemes, entrepreneurs, gives various types of subsidies, organises training etc. There is one Industrial Estate at Mangaldoi & 4 Commercial Estates. Besides, the DI&CC prepares action plan each year for establishment of industries, under its various schemes, NABARD also organises workshop/training in the district for promotion of rural Non-farm Sector. As per Economic survey of Assam 2021-22, there are 456 MSME units registered under UAM/UDYAM employing 6286 persons.

Govt of India has launched Prime Minsiter's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP) with up to 25% subsidy to promote self-employment in rural areas. It would positively impact credit flow.

3.2.1 Physical Infrastructure - Land and water is available for establishment of industries. However, transport facilities are not adequate. The District is not covered by railway. Power position in the district is not good, supply of electricity is inadequate and irregular and marked by low voltage.

There are 02 industrial/commercial estates at Mangaldoi (47Bigha) and Dalgaon (21 Bigha). At Mangaldoi there are 19 Sheds and houses Horlicks bottling plant, Britannia Cake manufacturing unit, ORS-L Manufacturing unit, Swarnaprabha Handmade paper unit, Rhino plastic/ moulded furniture unit etc. The Dalgaon centre houses Sanskar & Sanghi groups food processing units and other units.

There are no technical colleges / institutes in the district. However, there is a training centre for food processing/preservation under District Agriculture Office. There are a few Training-cum-Production Centres on Handloom, Handicraft, Knitting, Embroidery etc. UCO Rural Self Employment Training Institute (RSETI) is operating in the District and is at the forefront in imparting training to unemployed youths.

Handloom is an important household activity in the district. However, most of the looms are in the non-commercial sector and outside the cooperative system. Productivity of traditional loom is very low and mostly used for household needs. Some of the constraints in this sector are- large extent of dormancy, poor development of Cooperatives, lack of market oriented design, primitive looms & accessories and lack of entrepreneurial abilities.

3.2.2 Potential activities:

i) Export Oriented Projects

Cane, Bamboo, Honey, Ginger, Supari (processed betel nut), Handloom/ Sericulture products & Jute based products have demand in the export market. Development of Cane & Bamboo as well as Jute based products is of utmost importance to raise income and create employment in rural areas. Beekeeping is also an emerging area.

ii) Handicrafts

Handicrafts especially Cane & Bamboo works has been a popular activity. There is good potential for cane & bamboo {products made of Bamboo [as Kula, Chalani, Dala, Kharahi etc.- all traditionally used utilities; items as bamboo mat (dhari), bichoni (hand fan), bamboo tray etc.} in the district. Many SHGs have taken up production of bamboo furniture also have good scope.

Development Commissioner (Handicrafts), GOI's office at Gauripur (headed by Asst. Director) had identified one cluster for coverage under the 'Ambedkar Hastashilpa Protsahan Yojna'.

iii) Demand based industries

Bakery and biscuit making, candle, phenyl making, various types of plastic units including furniture, steel fabrication, soap making, brick making, aluminum utensils, inverters/voltage stabilisers, power looms, ice slab, engineering workshop, readymade garments, R.C.C. products, spice making, jute and plastic bag making, shoe making, lime colours, colour-laboratory for photo, Desk-Top printing etc..

iv) Skill based industries

Supari making units in Kharupetia, Mangaldoi, Kalaigaon; Pottery Making in Maroi, and Kharupetia areas are prominent. Location specific skill based activities such as, Knitting, tailoring and Decorative Textile, handloom weaving, Brass Metal making, coir based units from coconut fibre based on the pattern of Nalbari district, carpentry, blacksmith, goldsmith, bee keeping, papad making, woodcraft/furniture making can also be successfully undertaken in the district.

v) Apiculture

Beekeeping has the potential to be one of the most important enterprises giving incremental income to farm families. Making of Bee Boxes, Honey processing, processing of Bee Venom etc. are the downstream units possible from apiculture. Of late, Bee keeping has got an impetus on

account of initiatives of NABARD in the district. One Skill Development programme & one REDP had been conducted on beekeeping. Due to NABARDs efforts beekeeping has assumed organised shape in the district and credit flow has also began.

3.2.3 Industrial and Investment Policy of Assam, 2019

State Government is envisaging Assam as preferred destination for investment. The policy is valid for a period of 5 years w.e.f. 01-09-2019. Under the policy any eligible enterprise both in manufacturing as well as service sector unless specified in negative list can avail following benefits :

- Power Subsidy @ Rs.2 per unit for a period of 5 years subject to a maximum of Rs.50 lakh per annum.
- 50% Generating set subsidy subject to a ceiling of Rs.20 lakh.
- 100 % stamp duty exemption subject to a ceiling of Rs.25 lakh on purchase of land.
- 75% subsidy on Technology transfer subject to a ceiling of Rs.10 lakh.
- Financial Assistance to MSME @ 30% of the cost of Public Issue expenses subject to a ceiling of Rs.5 lakh for getting listed in Stock Exchange.
- 100 % stamp duty exemption subject to a ceiling of Rs.25 lakh on purchase of land.
- 75% subsidy on Technology transfer subject to a ceiling of Rs.10 lakh.
- Financial Assistance to MSME @ 30% of the cost of Public Issue expenses subject to a ceiling of Rs.5 lakh for getting listed in Stock Exchange.
- Financial assistance for Environmental Compliances @50% of the capital cost subject to a ceiling of Rs.25 lakh.

3.3 Assessment of Potential for the financial year 2024-25:

The Ground level credit flow to MSME sector during the last four years are as under:

(Rs in lakh)

2020-21	2021-22	2022-23
23096.15	13178.97	39342.56

(Source: LBO, Darrang and SLBC)

The assessment for term loan is as under-

(Rs. in lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
i	Micro Enterprise	25.000	530	13250.00	10600.00
ii	Small Enterprises	250.000	29	7250.00	5800.00
	Sub-Total		**559**	**20500.00**	**16400.00**

The assessment of working capital is as under-

(Rs. in lakh)

Sr. No.	Activity	PLP 2024-25			
		Unit cost	Phy Units	Fin. Outlay	Bank Loan
I	Micro Enterprises	10.000	600	6000.00	4800.00
Ii	Micro Enterprises – Existing	10.000	200	2000.00	1600.00
Iii	Small Enterprises	100.000	29	2900.00	2320.00
	Sub-Total		**829**	**10900.00**	**8720.00**
	Total		**1388**	**31400.00**	**25120.00**

Bank Loan is 80% of Total Financial Outlay/ Working Capital Requirement

The Block-wise and Sector-wise potential assessed for the year 2024-25 is indicated in Annexure-I.